

Carnet

The design book

Every design in the product: when it was made, why, what each part means, and why it works for the people who use it. Photographed from the running application.

Built on 14 September 2026, after Phase 40.

How to read this book

Carnet is a workshop management system built around one idea: a vehicle's history should belong to the car, not to the garage that happened to record it. Every design decision in the product serves that idea, or serves the three people who use the product on an ordinary day: the service advisor at the counter, the technician under the car, and the owner or driver reading their own record on a phone.

Each design below is described the same way. When it was made, by phase and date. Why it was made, meaning the problem it solves. What each part means, because nothing on a Carnet screen is decoration: every colour, every mark and every figure carries a fact. And why it works, meaning why this design rather than the obvious one. Under each is a photograph taken from the application itself, with its seeded demonstration data, so the picture is the product and not a mock-up of it.

The rules behind every design live in the design documents in the repository, and each section names the one to open. This book is the tour; those are the law.

Contents

1. The identity: colour, type, and the rule that colour never carries meaning alone
2. The mark: a passport booklet, on the tab and beside the name
3. The front door and the passport as an object
4. Signing in, signing up, and the region
5. The workshop shell and the dashboard
6. The diary and the floor
7. The job: the central screen
8. The shop floor and the inspection
9. The estimate, approved on a phone
10. The invoice and the money cycle
11. The counter
12. Gift cards
13. The customer: points, referrals and the whole story
14. The vehicle and its passport
15. Passports, listed
16. The portal
17. Reputation, answers, people and the business
18. Dark mode, empty states and the page that is not there
19. What the design refuses to do

1. The identity

Colour drawn from an engine bay

Phase 1, 9 September 2026, in the design system; refined through Phase 23.

WHY IT WAS MADE

The product uses red, amber and green constantly: inspection severity, job status, capacity, the sign of a ledger figure. The brand colour therefore cannot be any of them and cannot sit next to any of them. Blue collides with the diary's information state, green with a pass, orange with an advisory and with the incumbent competitor, red with a critical finding. What is left is petrol, which is dark enough for white text at every usable tint, distinct from all four, and drawn from the subject.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- Petrol is the brand: primary buttons, links, the active state in the sidebar, the sign-in panel.
- Brass is the accent, spent sparingly: the focus ring, section numbering, and the passport's foil. If brass were everywhere it would be nowhere.
- The neutrals are a slate scale biased a few degrees toward petrol, so greys read as chosen rather than inherited.
- Success, warning, danger and info each have a light and a dark value, and each means one thing in this product: paid, awaiting a customer, a broken chain, in progress.

WHY IT WORKS

Colour never carries meaning alone. Every status badge has a label; every severity has a glyph as well as a hue. The inspection summary reads as a cross, a mark and a tick with counts, which survives a black-and-white print, a sunlit tablet and a reader who cannot tell the hues apart. The palette is therefore not a mood but a constraint satisfied, and it looks deliberate because it is.

TUESDAY, 15 SEPTEMBER 2026

Good afternoon, Ahmed

Open diary | New job

TODAY

JOBS TODAY	VEHICLES IN SHOP	AWAITING APPROVAL	TAKEN TODAY
0	3	2	£0.00
Created since midnight	Physically on site	Work is blocked	Payments received

PAST THE PROMISE	BOOKED TODAY	ON THE CLOCK
3	0	0
Due back and not finished	Appointments in the diary	Clocked on to a job now

Approvals needed

Nothing can proceed on these until the customer decides.

See all

BMW X5 `MK20 XRT` #10482
Maria Okonkwo · Brake system repair · waiting 99h
£1,509.00 Review

Vauxhall Vivaro `BX70 KHT` #10483
Pennine Plumbing Ltd · Clutch judder under load
Review

Today in the workshop

0 bookings scheduled

Diary

Nothing booked today

An empty diary is as much of a problem as a full one.

Add a booking

THE BUSINESS

OWED TO YOU	OVERDUE	COMEBACKS	SATISFACTION
£2,401.20	£2,034.00	0	—
Issued and not yet paid	2 invoices past their due date	Back out of 1 finished in 90 days, too few for a rate	Too few answers to compare

This month

Arithmetic with a sentence around it, from the same figures as the reports.

Ask a question

£237 invoiced in September 2026 across 1 job, £237 a job.

Gross margin 48%.

INVENTORY

SHORT	ORDERS LATE	WAITING FOR PARTS	STOCK VALUE
4	0	0	£1,737.30
Below reorder point, nothing on order	Past the day the supplier promised	Approved, and nothing on the shelf	On the shelf at average cost

Short now

Each opens the part, with every supplier side by side.

Brake fluid DOT 4, 1L BRK-FLUID-1L	-2 available, reorder at 10
Oil filter 04152-YZZA1	5 available, reorder at 12
BMW front brake discs (pair) 34116864059	0 available, reorder at 4
Battery 90Ah AGM BAT-090-AGM	0 available, reorder at 2

What's happening

Everything the workshop has done, newest first.

Ahmed Bakri assistant exchange organization	13:47
Ahmed Bakri referral issued customer	13:44
Ahmed Bakri referral issued customer	13:43
Ahmed Bakri package reactivated servicepackage	13:42
Ahmed Bakri package retired servicepackage	13:42
Ahmed Bakri job completed job	13:42
Ahmed Bakri job in progress job	13:42
Ahmed Bakri booking converted booking	13:42
Ahmed Bakri job created job	13:42
Ahmed Bakri booking created booking	13:42

The workshop dashboard: petrol for the brand, the four semantic colours each doing one job.

Source: docs/02-design/08-design-system.md, sections 1 to 3

Three faces, one of them for data

Phase 1, 9 September 2026; Fraunces added for the passport in Phase 23.

WHY IT WAS MADE

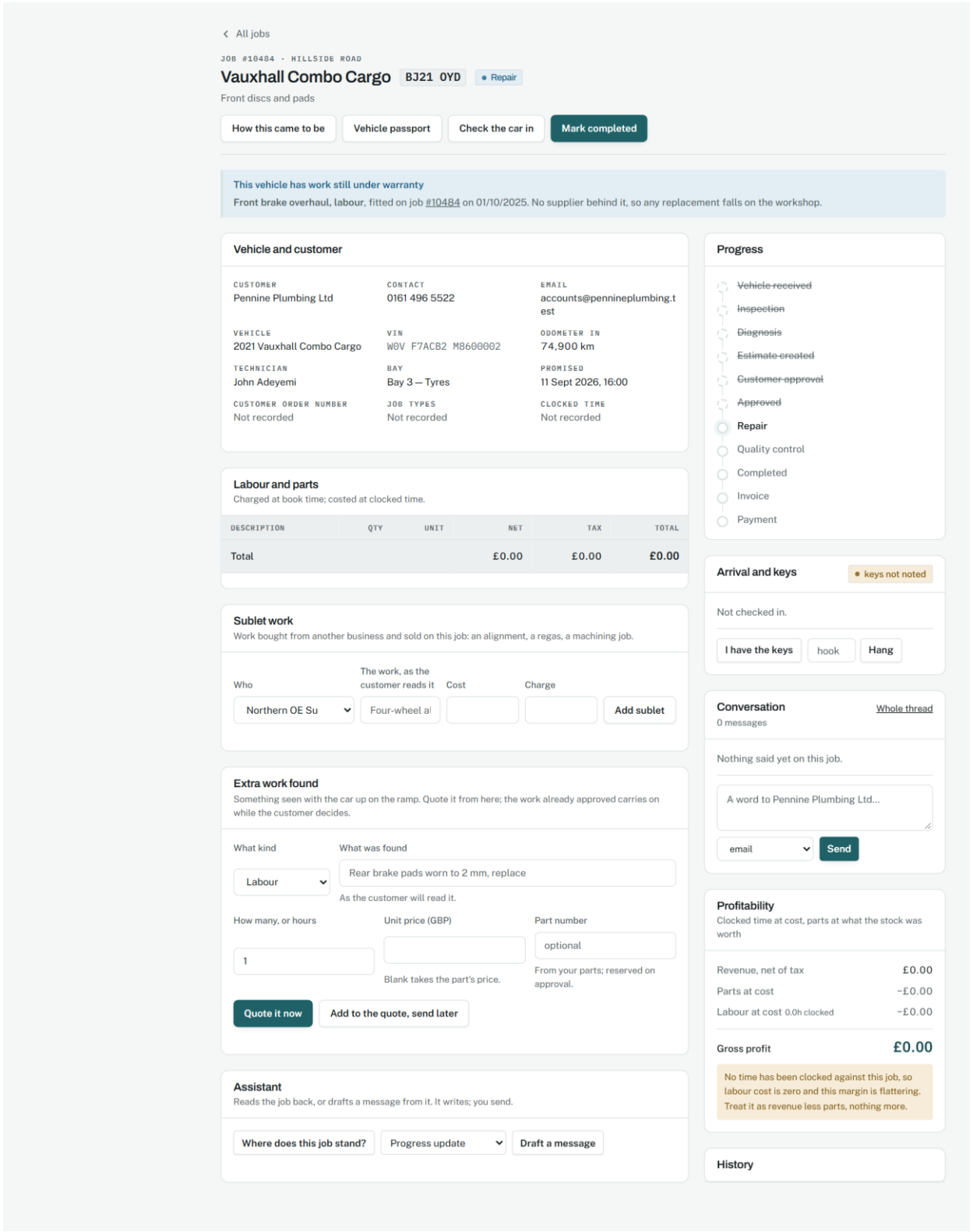
A workshop interface lives at thirteen pixels in dense tables, and its most important strings are read character by character: a VIN against the plate on a windscreen, a part number against a box. A proportional face makes the digit one, the capital I and the lower-case L ambiguous, and in this product that means merging two vehicles' histories.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- Archivo for display: industrial signage character, slightly condensed so a long vehicle description fits a table heading.
- Public Sans for the interface: neutral and legible at thirteen pixels, the size most of the workshop surface is set at.
- IBM Plex Mono for data: VINs, registrations, part numbers, job numbers, hashes and every figure in a column.
- Fraunces, used nowhere but the passport, so the document keeps a face of its own.

WHY IT WORKS

Body text is thirteen pixels on the desktop and fifteen on the shop floor and the portal, because a wall-mounted tablet is at arm's length and a phone is read outdoors. Radii are small and elevation is border first, shadow only when something genuinely lifts off the page, so the product looks like an instrument rather than a consumer app.



The job screen: three faces at work, the data face on every identifier.

Source: docs/02-design/08-design-system.md, sections 4 and 5

2. The mark

A passport booklet, on the tab and beside the name

Phase 27, 14 September 2026. The site had no favicon before, and the headers carried a clock.

WHY IT WAS MADE

A clock said "time" about a product whose subject is a record. The passport is the product's one idea, so the mark is the passport: a booklet with the wheel from its cover. One drawing serves the favicon, the app icon, the home-screen icon and the mark beside the name in every header, so a person meets the same shape wherever they meet the product.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

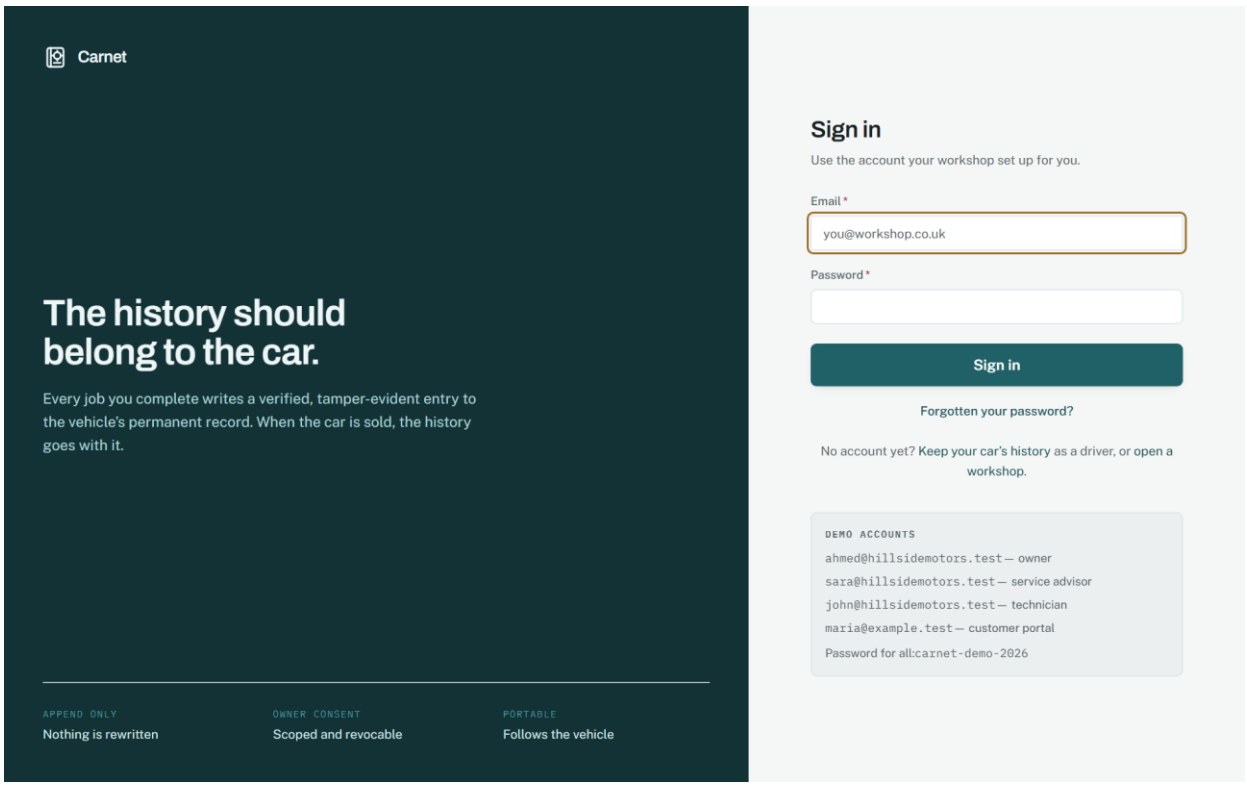
- The petrol ground shows against a light tab bar and a dark one.
- The booklet is near-black with a darker spine: a cover, not a card.
- The wheel is the foil emblem from the passport's cover, drawn heavy enough to survive sixteen pixels.
- The two lines at the foot are the machine-readable zone, the part of a passport that a machine checks.
- In a header the mark is one colour, so it takes the brand tint on white and the paper tint on petrol.

WHY IT WORKS

The name beside it stays "Carnet", alone. A carnet is a booklet of papers a vehicle carries, so the name already says passport; adding the word would make the wordmark longer and less sure of itself. The tagline says it in plain words where a tagline belongs.



The mark as the home screen sees it.



The mark beside the name on the sign-in panel.

Source: docs/02-design/08-design-system.md, section 12

---

3. The front door

The passport as an object you can open

Phase 4.5, 9 September 2026, as a marketing page; the vehicle in three dimensions in Phase 7; the booklet in Phase 23, 12 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

Every competitor renders a service history as a list in a card, which is what a history looks like when it belongs to a database. Carnet's claim is that the history belongs to the car, so the front door opens with the document a car would carry: a closed passport that tilts toward the pointer and opens on a press, with the demonstration vehicle turning in its photograph window and its real record pressed on the page as stamps.

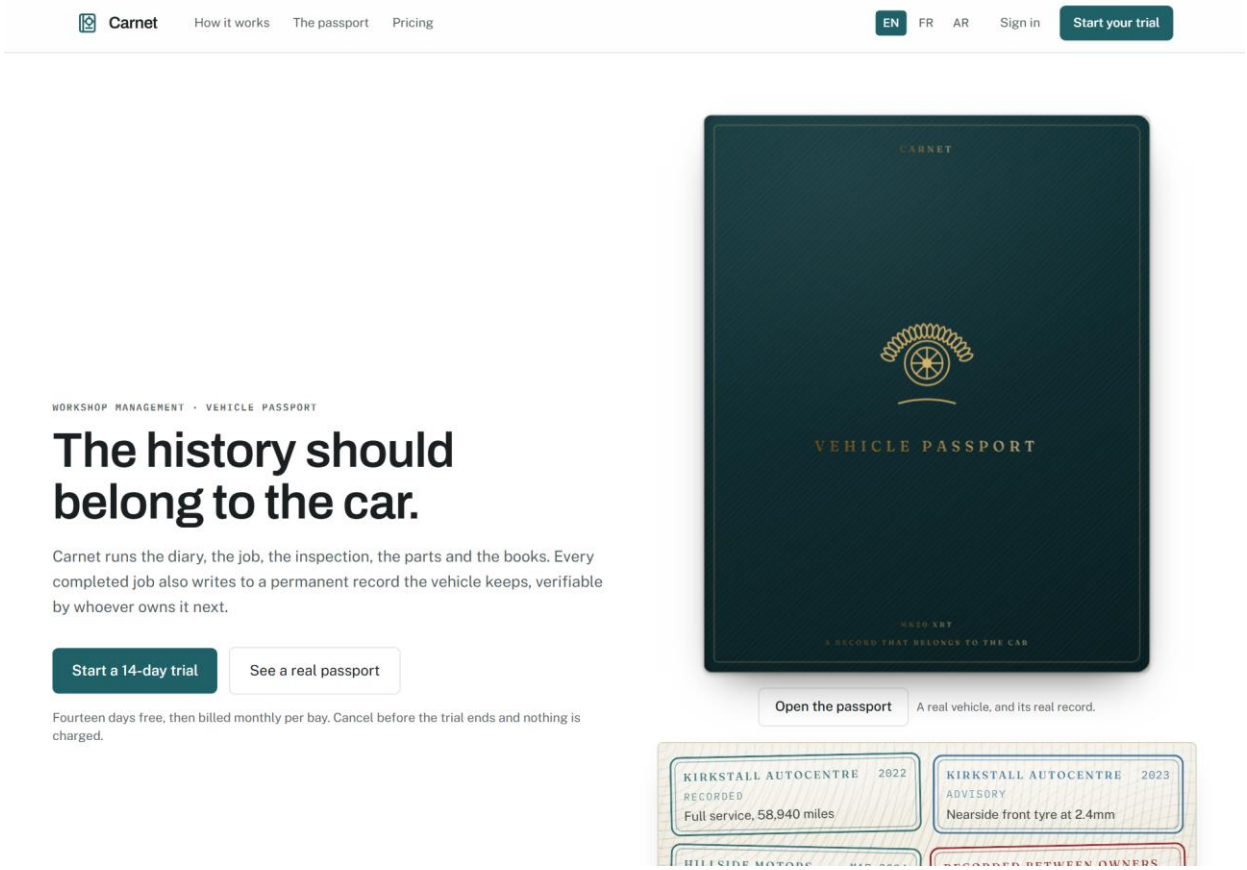
WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The cover is petrol deepened to leatherette, with the emblem and the title in brass foil.
- Inside, the fields read in a passport's order: type, code, number, then the vehicle.
- The chosen entry is pressed on the page as a stamp, inked by how well evidenced it is.
- The machine-readable zone runs along the foot and checks, digit for digit, the way a travel document's does.

WHY IT WORKS

A diagram of a history is a diagram. A passport you can open is the product's argument made physical, and it is the one thing on the page a competitor cannot copy, because they do not have a record that

belongs to the car. It is still a page: the button that opens it is a real button, the entries below are real buttons carrying the same text as the stamps, and reduced motion opens the cover without animating.



The home page: the booklet, closed, tilting toward the pointer.

Source: docs/02-design/10-passport-design.md, section 2

---

4. Signing in

A sign-in that says which system this is

Phase 1, 9 September 2026; password reset and email confirmation in Phase 15.1.

WHY IT WAS MADE

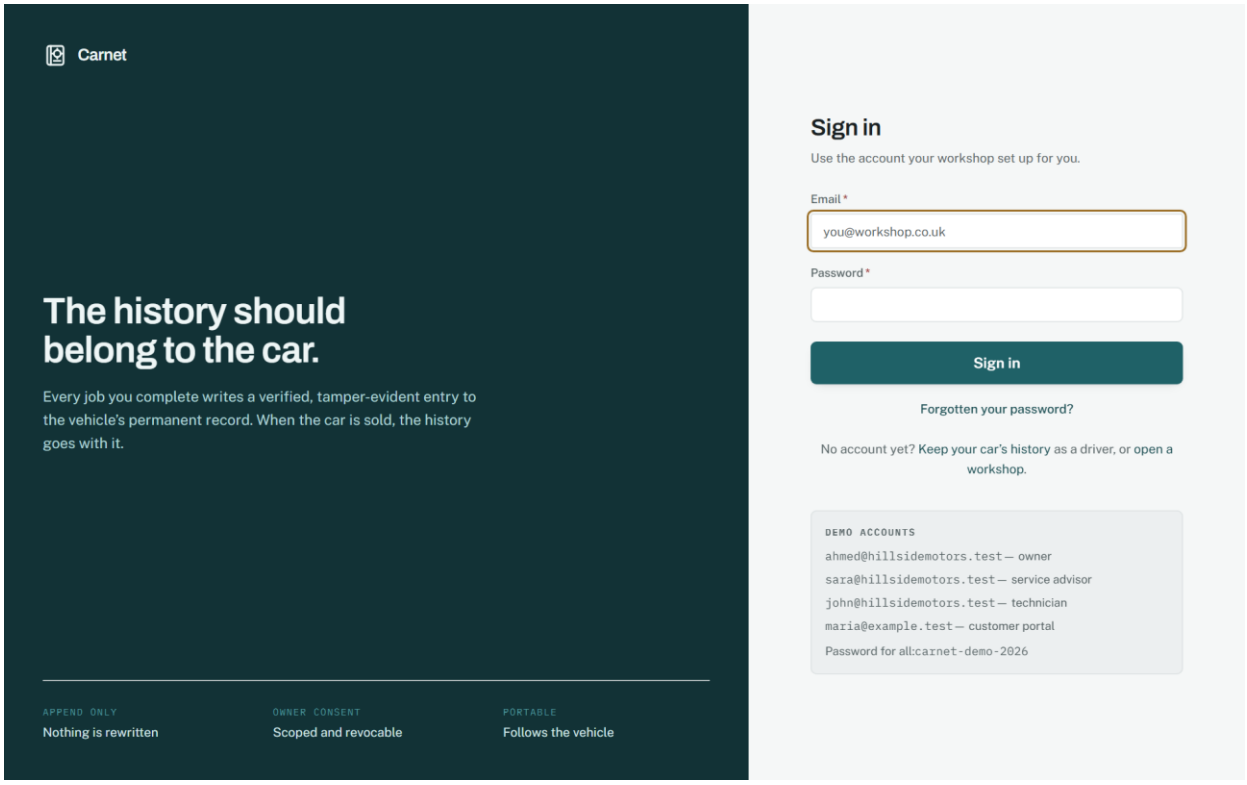
A service advisor signing in on a shared machine at the counter should know which system this is before typing a password. The petrol panel with the mark and the product's pitch is not decoration; it is the label on the door.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The petrol panel carries the mark and the name in the paper tint, and the promise in one sentence.
- The form is a single column with a real label on every field and a brass focus ring.
- The reset and confirmation pages share the same panel, so a person coming back from an email is still in the same building.

WHY IT WORKS

First-party sessions, a cookie that the browser cannot read, and a token that is stored only as a digest. The design is quiet because the security is not visible and should not need to be.



Sign in.

Source: docs/02-design/05-security-model.md, sections 1 to 3

Signing up, and the region a workshop lives in

Phase 4.5, 9 September 2026; the country added in Phase 29, 14 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

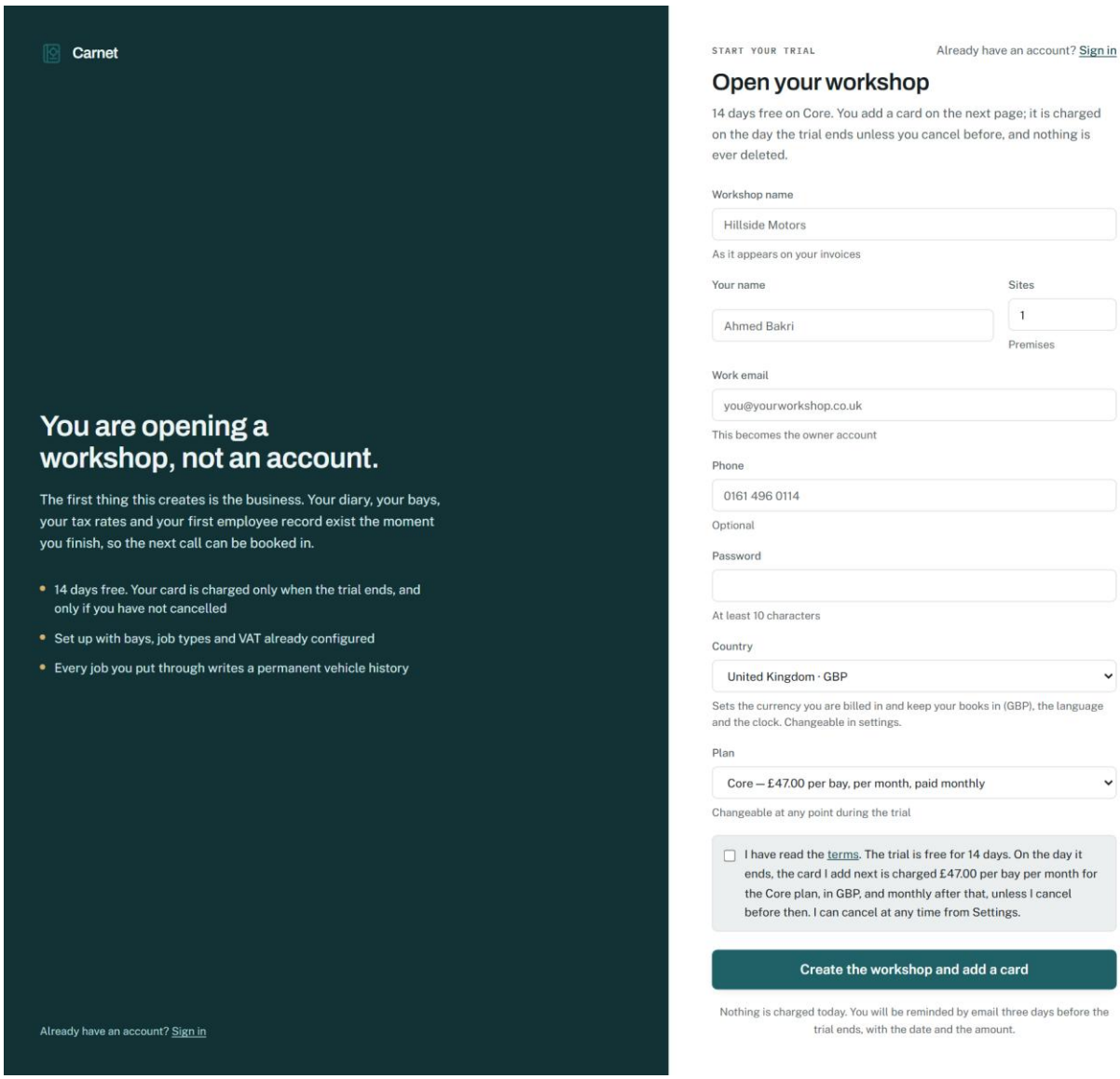
Signing up creates a workshop, not an account, so the form asks for the business first and the person second. In Phase 29 it asks for the country before either, because a workshop keeps one set of books in one currency and everything else follows: the currency, the language and region dates are written in, the clock, and the first tax rate.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

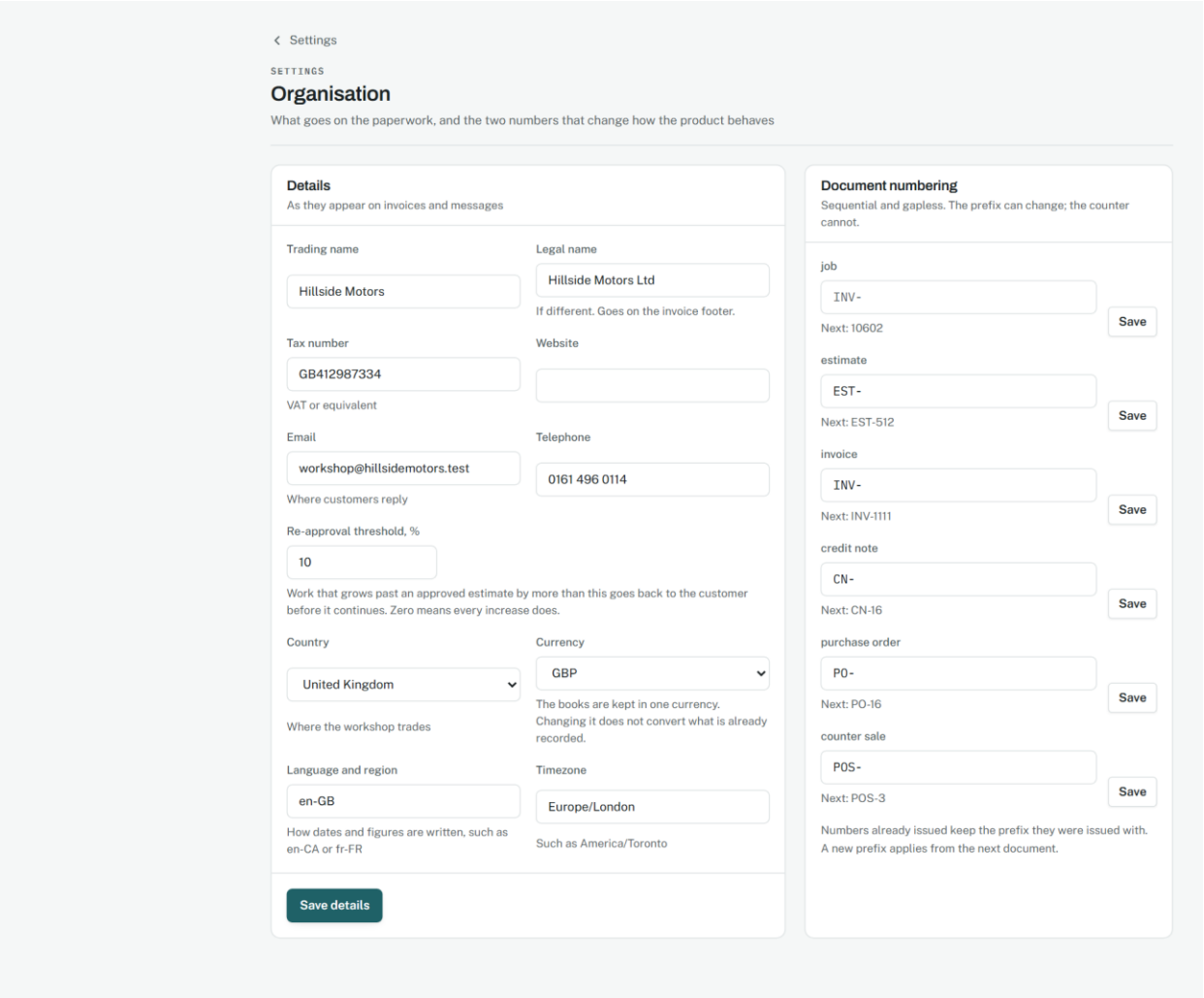
- One picker, and four facts written from it. Nothing else in the product has to know a country exists.
- The organisation settings page shows all four and lets the owner change them, with the currency carrying the one warning that matters: nothing already recorded is converted.
- Every page then formats money and dates from the workshop's region rather than from a default; a driver in the portal sees each amount in the currency it was billed in.

WHY IT WORKS

A Canadian workshop sees dollars, Canadian dates and GST from the first screen, and a British one is exactly as it was. The rule is that no figure or date reaches a person formatted by a default, and it is written into the design system so a page that forgets is a defect rather than a habit.



Sign-up, with the country first.



The organisation settings, where the region can be changed.

Source: docs/02-design/08-design-system.md, section 12.5; packages/core/src/region/countries.ts

---

5. The workshop shell and the dashboard

A sidebar grouped by what somebody is doing

Phase 1, 9 September 2026; reorganised in Phase 3 and pruned by role in Phase 4.

WHY IT WAS MADE

With ninety-four pages, a flat list of links is a wall. The sidebar is grouped into Workshop, Money, Inventory, People and Settings, filtered by the role of the person signed in so a technician never sees the ledger, and the active item is marked in petrol.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- Each group is a kind of work, not a kind of table.
- A thin rule appears under the item you pressed while the next page loads, so the answer to "did that register?" is on the thing you pressed.
- The organisation and the site are named at the foot, because a person at a group can be at any of them.

WHY IT WORKS

Nothing in the sidebar is a promise the product cannot keep. The controls crawl reads every page for every role and fails on a link that goes nowhere, so the shell is verified as well as designed.

TUESDAY, 15 SEPTEMBER 2026

Good afternoon, Ahmed

Open diary | New job

TODAY

JOBS TODAY	VEHICLES IN SHOP	AWAITING APPROVAL	TAKEN TODAY
0	3	2	£0.00
Created since midnight	Physically on site	Work is blocked	Payments received

PAST THE PROMISE	BOOKED TODAY	ON THE CLOCK
3	0	0
Due back and not finished	Appointments in the diary	Clocked on to a job now

Approvals needed

Nothing can proceed on these until the customer decides.

See all

BMW X5 `MK20 XRT` #10482
Maria Okonkwo · Brake system repair · waiting 99h
£1,509.00 Review

Vauxhall Vivaro `BX70 KHT` #10483
Pennine Plumbing Ltd · Clutch judder under load
Review

Today in the workshop

0 bookings scheduled

Diary

Nothing booked today

An empty diary is as much of a problem as a full one.

Add a booking

THE BUSINESS

OWED TO YOU	OVERDUE	COMEBACKS	SATISFACTION
£2,401.20	£2,034.00	0	—
Issued and not yet paid	2 invoices past their due date	Back out of 1 finished in 90 days, too few for a rate	Too few answers to compare

This month

Arithmetic with a sentence around it, from the same figures as the reports.

Ask a question

£237 invoiced in September 2026 across 1 job, £237 a job.

Gross margin 48%.

INVENTORY

SHORT	ORDERS LATE	WAITING FOR PARTS	STOCK VALUE
4	0	0	£1,737.30
Below reorder point, nothing on order	Past the day the supplier promised	Approved, and nothing on the shelf	On the shelf at average cost

Short now

Each opens the part, with every supplier side by side.

Brake fluid DOT 4, 1L BRK-FLUID-1L	-2 available, reorder at 10
Oil filter 04152-YZZA1	5 available, reorder at 12
BMW front brake discs (pair) 34116864059	0 available, reorder at 4
Battery 90Ah AGM BAT-090-AGM	0 available, reorder at 2

What's happening

Everything the workshop has done, newest first.

Ahmed Bakri assistant exchange organization	13:47
Ahmed Bakri referral issued customer	13:44
Ahmed Bakri referral issued customer	13:43
Ahmed Bakri package reactivated servicepackage	13:42
Ahmed Bakri package retired servicepackage	13:42
Ahmed Bakri job completed job	13:42
Ahmed Bakri job in progress job	13:42
Ahmed Bakri booking converted booking	13:42
Ahmed Bakri job created job	13:42
Ahmed Bakri booking created booking	13:42

The shell around the dashboard.

Source: docs/02-design/09-wireframes.md, section 1; docs/00-product/09-feature-map.md, section 21

The dashboard: today, then the money

Phase 1, 9 September 2026; rebuilt from real figures in Phase 4.9 and Phase 17.

WHY IT WAS MADE

An owner opening the product in the morning has six questions: what is booked, what is in, what is waiting on a customer, what is waiting on parts, what is past its promise, and what was taken. The dashboard answers those in tiles and then shows the floor and the reminders.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- A tile changes colour only when its figure means somebody must act today.
- The floor is the bays as they stand, with the car and the technician on each.
- The month view is the diary's shape at a glance.

WHY IT WORKS

Every figure is derived from the records rather than stored, so the dashboard cannot disagree with the pages behind it, and the same figures answer the questions typed at /ask.

TUESDAY, 15 SEPTEMBER 2026

Good afternoon, Ahmed

Open diary | New job

TODAY

JOBS TODAY	VEHICLES IN SHOP	AWAITING APPROVAL	TAKEN TODAY
0	3	2	£0.00
Created since midnight	Physically on site	Work is blocked	Payments received

PAST THE PROMISE	BOOKED TODAY	ON THE CLOCK
3	0	0
Due back and not finished	Appointments in the diary	Clocked on to a job now

Approvals needed

Nothing can proceed on these until the customer decides.

See all

BMW X5 `MK20 XRT` #10482
Maria Okonkwo · Brake system repair · waiting 99h
£1,509.00 Review

Vauxhall Vivaro `BX70 KHT` #10483
Pennine Plumbing Ltd · Clutch judder under load
Review

Today in the workshop

0 bookings scheduled

Diary

Nothing booked today

An empty diary is as much of a problem as a full one.

Add a booking

THE BUSINESS

OWED TO YOU	OVERDUE	COMEBACKS	SATISFACTION
£2,401.20	£2,034.00	0	—
Issued and not yet paid	2 invoices past their due date	Back out of 1 finished in 90 days, too few for a rate	Too few answers to compare

This month

Arithmetic with a sentence around it, from the same figures as the reports.

Ask a question

£237 invoiced in September 2026 across 1 job, £237 a job.

Gross margin 48%.

INVENTORY

SHORT	ORDERS LATE	WAITING FOR PARTS	STOCK VALUE
4	0	0	£1,737.30
Below reorder point, nothing on order	Past the day the supplier promised	Approved, and nothing on the shelf	On the shelf at average cost

Short now

Each opens the part, with every supplier side by side.

Brake fluid DOT 4, 1L BRK-FLUID-1L	-2 available, reorder at 10
Oil filter 04152-YZZA1	5 available, reorder at 12
BMW front brake discs (pair) 34116864059	0 available, reorder at 4
Battery 90Ah AGM BAT-090-AGM	0 available, reorder at 2

What's happening

Everything the workshop has done, newest first.

Ahmed Bakri assistant exchange organization	13:47
Ahmed Bakri referral issued customer	13:44
Ahmed Bakri referral issued customer	13:43
Ahmed Bakri package reactivated servicepackage	13:42
Ahmed Bakri package retired servicepackage	13:42
Ahmed Bakri job completed job	13:42
Ahmed Bakri job in progress job	13:42
Ahmed Bakri booking converted booking	13:42
Ahmed Bakri job created job	13:42
Ahmed Bakri booking created booking	13:42

The dashboard.

Source: docs/02-design/09-wireframes.md, section 2

---

6. The diary and the floor

A diary with lanes, and cards that move

Phase 1, 9 September 2026; six views and drag in Phase 8, 10 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

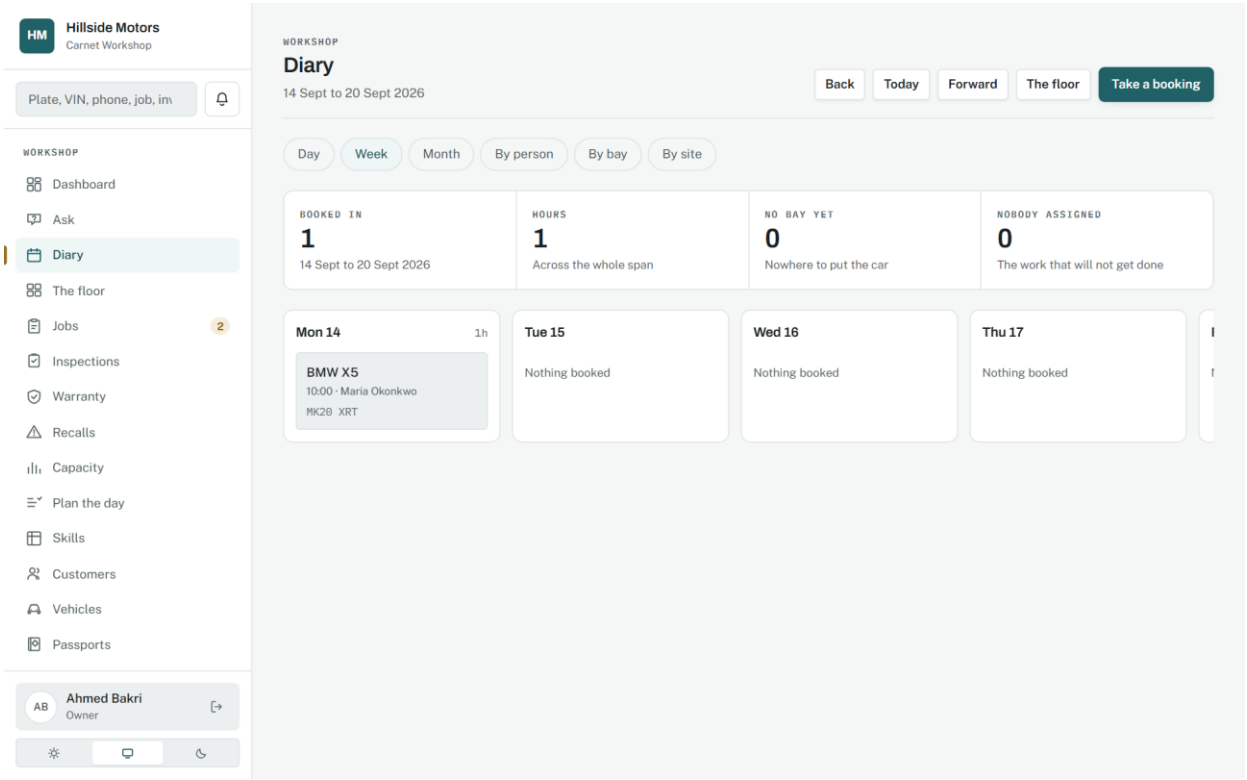
A workshop's day is bays and technicians against hours. A calendar that shows appointments as a list cannot show that bay two is free at eleven. The diary shows lanes by bay and by technician, in day, week and month, and a booking is a card that can be dragged to another lane or time, with the diary having the last word on whether it fits.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

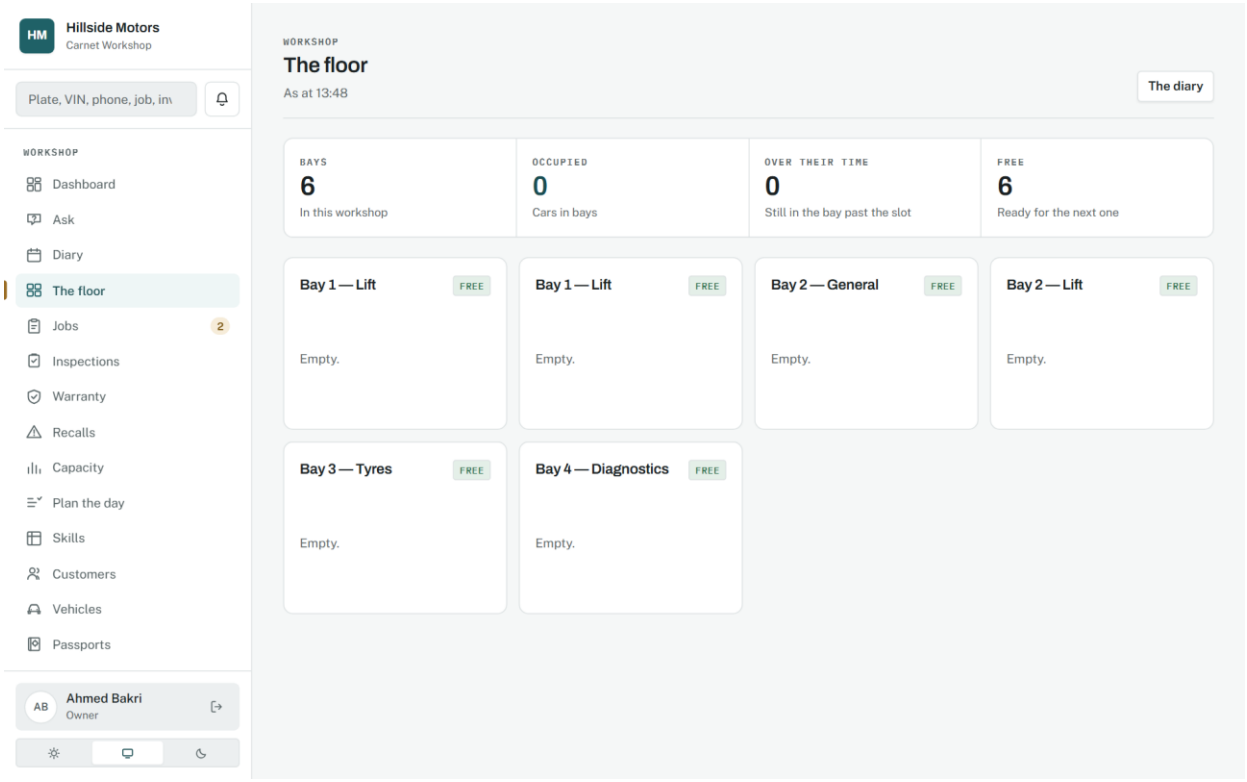
- The registration on each card is drawn as a plate, recognisable at a glance across a busy day.
- A card's colour is the job type, never the status; status is a badge with a word.
- Capacity is a bar under each day: hours the site can absorb against hours booked.

WHY IT WORKS

Drag is a convenience layered over a form that works without it. A keyboard user and a tablet with a dodgy touch screen get the same diary, and every move is written to the job's history with who made it.



The diary.



The floor: the bays as they stand.

Source: docs/00-product/06-roadmap.md, Phase 8

---

7. The job

The central screen

Phase 1, 9 September 2026; the assistant added in Phase 22.

WHY IT WAS MADE

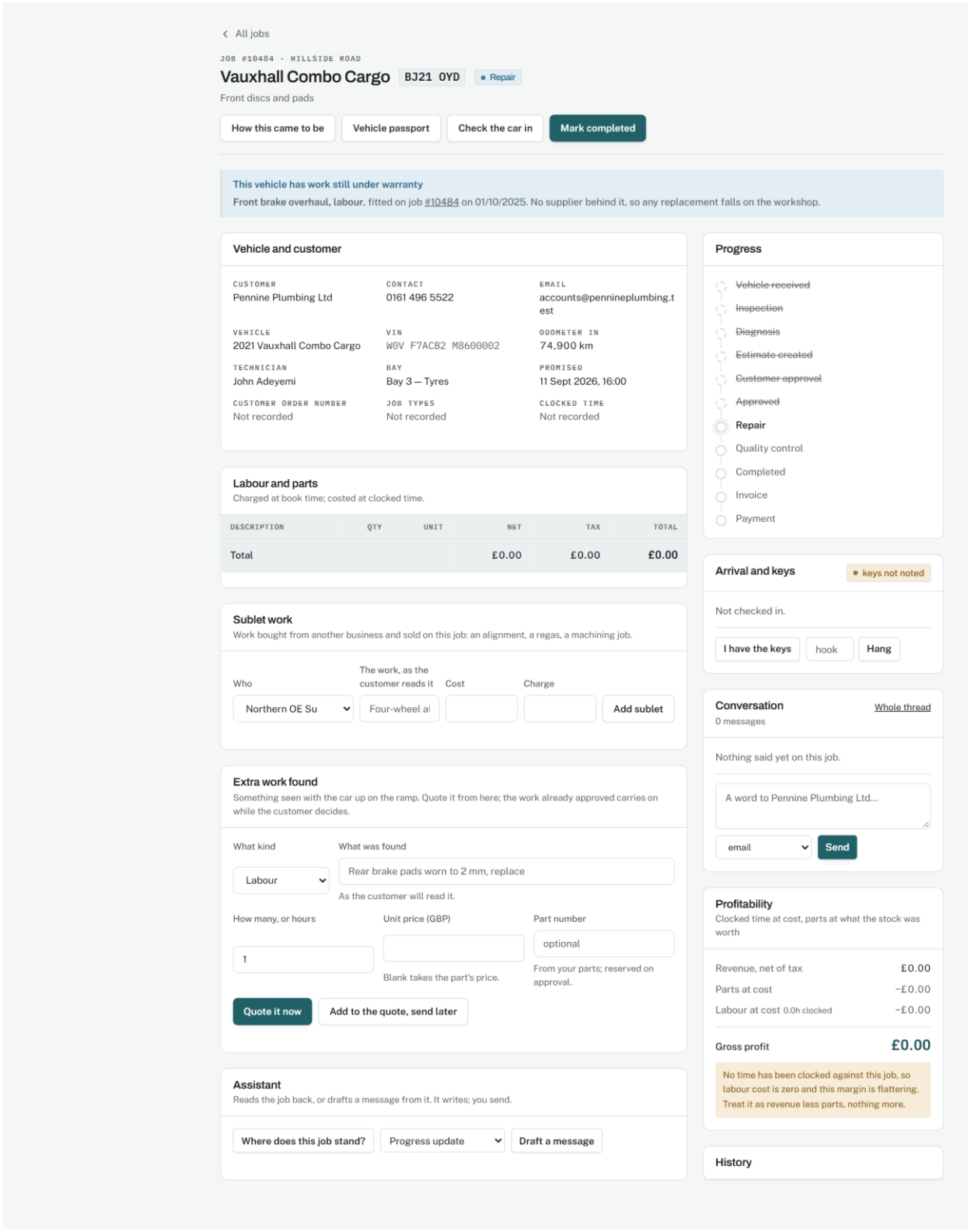
Every other part of the product exists to feed or consume the job. The screen puts the customer, the vehicle and the complaint at the top, the lifecycle as a trail, and then labour, parts, inspection, estimate, invoice and history as sections down the page, so nobody opens four screens to answer "where does this job stand?".

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The progress trail is the state machine drawn: each step is a real transition and an illegal one is refused with the permitted next steps named.
- A part line carries its reservation state and a fitment warning if the part does not fit this vehicle.
- The assistant's explanation of the job is composed from the record and decides nothing.

WHY IT WORKS

The job is the aggregate the domain layer defends, and the screen is that aggregate laid out. Nothing on it can be edited into an impossible state, because the transitions are the only way to move it.



A job in progress, top to bottom.

Source: docs/02-design/09-wireframes.md, section 3; docs/02-design/04-state-machines.md, section 1

8. The shop floor and the inspection

A tablet for oily hands

Phase 7, 10 September 2026; offline in Phase 14, 11 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

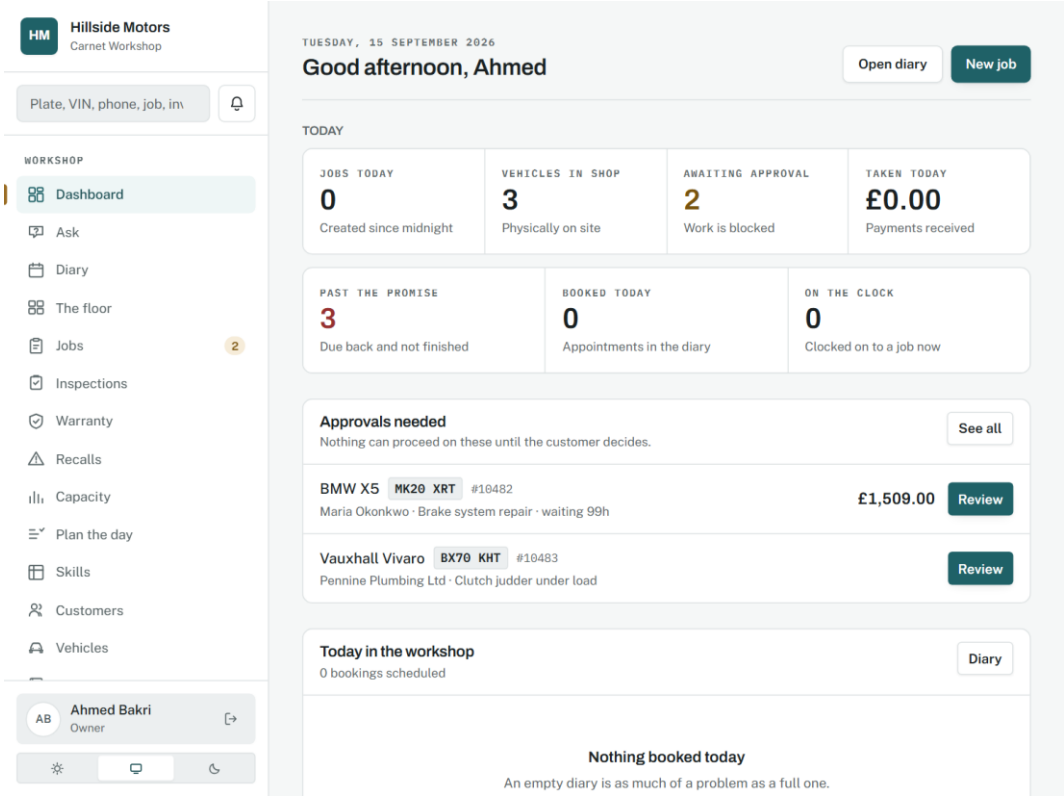
A technician standing in a workshop with oily hands, interrupted every few minutes, cannot use a desktop interface. The shop floor is a separate surface: fifteen-pixel type, forty-eight pixel targets, no hover anywhere, and nothing held in the browser that a sleeping tablet could lose.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

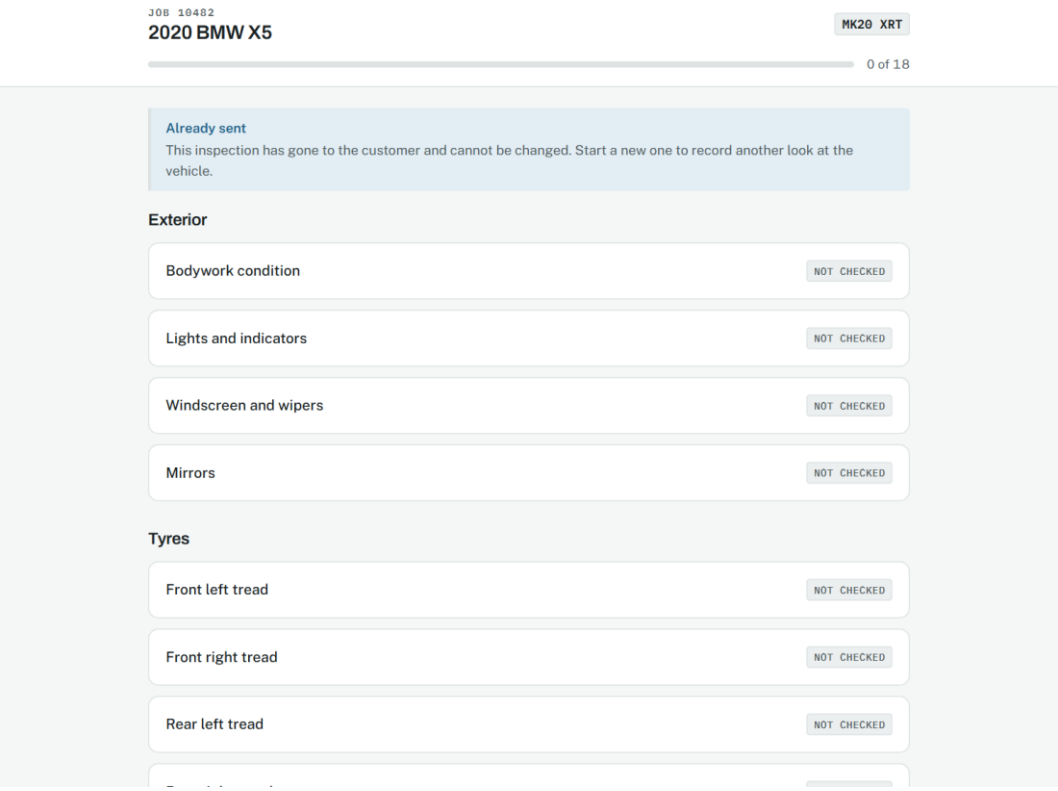
- Each inspection item saves the moment it is answered; there is no submit button at the end.
- Three large buttons per item: green, amber, red. Amber and red open a reason, and the reason is required, because a red the workshop cannot explain is worse than no inspection.
- Nothing is preselected and unchecked items stay unchecked, so a tick never means "I wanted to leave".
- With no signal, actions queue on the device and replay in order when it returns; a conflict stays on the device with a reason rather than silently winning.

WHY IT WORKS

The photographs are the trust mechanism: an advisory with a picture is worth more to a customer than a line of text, and the passport carries the same evidence to the next owner. The surface rules are binding, and a hover-dependent control on the floor is treated as a defect.



The shop floor: today's jobs and the clock.



An inspection in progress.

Source: docs/02-design/09-wireframes.md, sections 5 and 6; ADR-0012

---

9. The estimate, approved on a phone

Approval item by item, in under a minute

Phase 1, 9 September 2026; item-by-item decisions in Phase 5.1, 9 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

A customer in a supermarket car park is asked to approve brake work by a link in a text. They do not have an account and do not want one. The page shows each recommended item with its photograph, its plain-English meaning and its price, and lets them say yes to some and no to others.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- Plain language throughout: two millimetres of tread is stated alongside what it means.
- Each decision is recorded with the time, the address it came from and the exact total agreed.
- The approved items become lines on the job without anybody retyping them.

WHY IT WORKS

The MVP condition is that this takes under sixty seconds. The page has one task and no navigation, and the approve button is the largest thing on it.

HILLSIDE MOTORS

A quote for your 2020 BMW X5

Brake system repair · MK20 XRT

What we recommend

Tick what you would like done. Anything left unticked will not be carried out.

☐	Brake inspection	£95.00
☐	Front brake pad and disc replacement	£332.50
☐	BMW front brake pad set	£420.00
☐	BMW front brake discs (pair)	£410.00
☐	Front left tyre — Michelin 265/50 R19 OPTIONAL	£165.00
☐	Battery — 90Ah AGM OPTIONAL	£240.00

Before tax, if you take everything	£1,257.50
Tax	£251.50
Total	**£1,509.00**

You will only be charged for what you tick. This price holds until 25 September.

From the workshop

Front brakes only. Tyre and battery quoted separately as advisories.

Your name *

So the workshop knows who agreed to the work.

Anything to add?

Optional.

Sending this tells the workshop exactly which items to carry out. Anything you have left unticked will not be done, and will stay on the vehicle's record as recommended work that was turned down.

Send my answer

An estimate as the customer sees it.

Source: docs/02-design/09-wireframes.md, section 7

---

10. The invoice and the money cycle

Three forms, not three modals

Phase 3, 9 September 2026; the full cycle in Phase 16, 12 September 2026; points and gift cards in Phases 24 and 26.

WHY IT WAS MADE

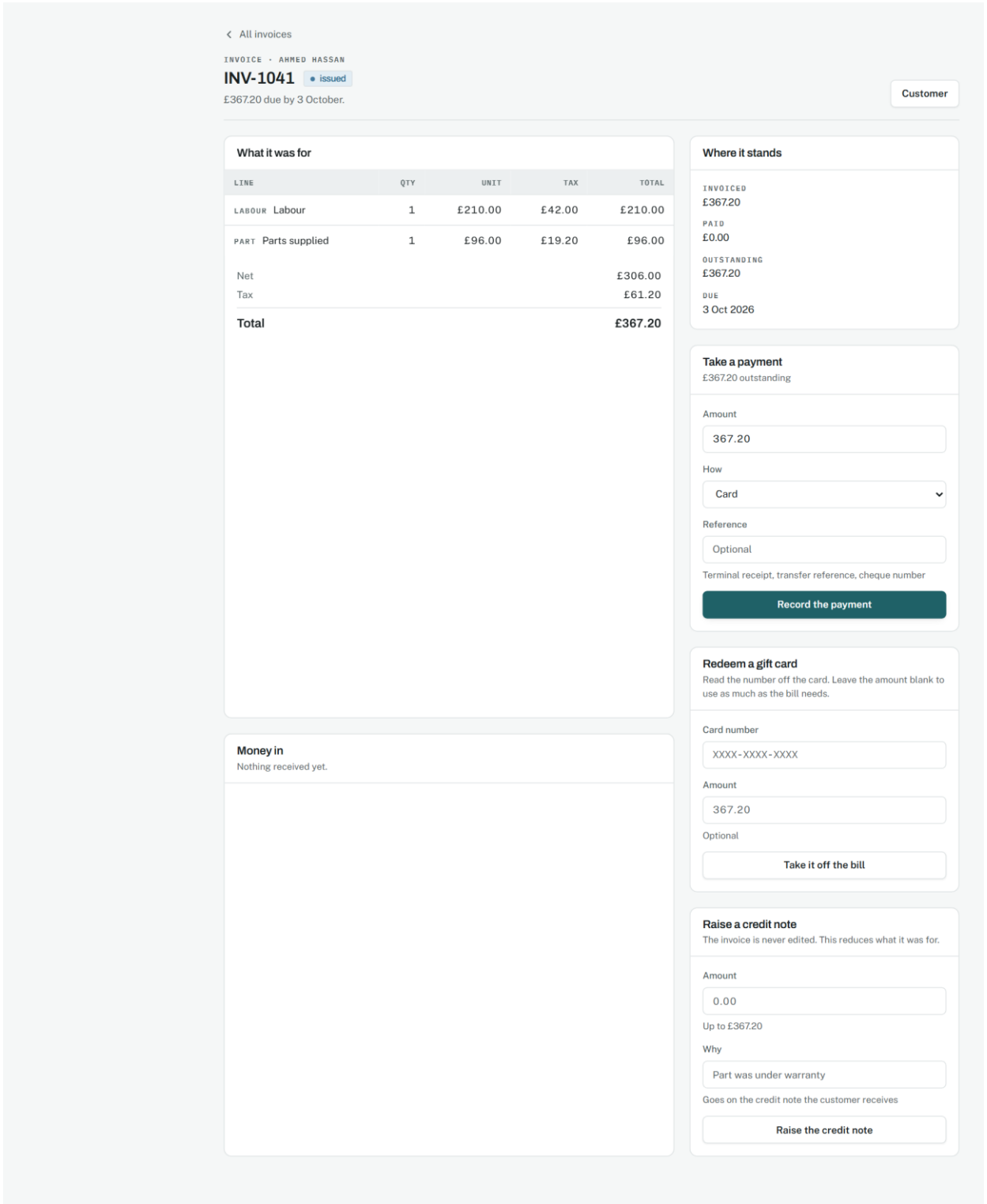
An issued invoice is immutable. What a person can do is take a payment, raise a credit note, send money back, take points off, or redeem a gift card, and each is a form on the page that refuses with a sentence when it would make the figures wrong.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- "Where it stands" is invoiced, paid, credited, refunded, outstanding and owed back, each derived.
- "Use their points" appears only when there is a bill to put them against and points to put.
- "Redeem a gift card" takes the number and an optional amount; blank means as much as the bill needs.
- Every payment posts to the ledger in the same request, so the books and the page never disagree.

WHY IT WORKS

Refusing rather than clamping is the rule. Quietly using fewer points than somebody asked for produces a bill they did not expect, and they find out at the counter.



An invoice with something owed.

Source: docs/02-design/07-accounting-model.md, sections 3.3, 3.9, 3.13 and 3.15

Money held, and a receipt in the hand

Phase 30, 14 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

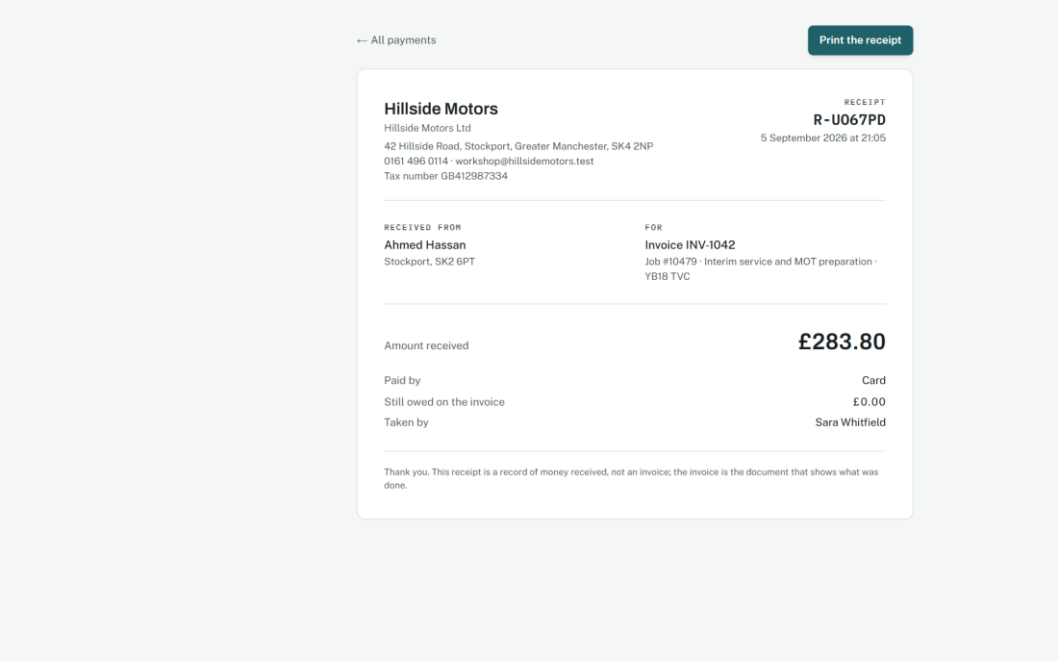
A workshop takes money before parts are ordered, and sometimes owes a regular customer twenty pounds they would rather keep on account. Neither is revenue, and both used to be a flag in the ledger with no screen. Now a deposit is taken on the customer's page, a refund can be kept as credit, and either goes against the next bill in one press. And every payment produces a receipt, because a person at a counter is handed paper.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The Money held card leads with the figure and lists each deposit or credit with what is left on it and a way to give it back, with a reason.
- On the invoice, "Use money held" takes as much as the bill needs unless an amount is typed, oldest first, refused rather than clamped.
- The receipt is one payment on one sheet: who paid, how much, how, for what, and what is still owed. The chrome hides when it prints.

WHY IT WORKS

Money held is a payment of its own kind when it meets a bill, so the books release the liability and never see the bank twice. What is held is never stored: it is what came in less what went out, and every movement says why.



A receipt, as it prints.

Source: docs/02-design/07-accounting-model.md, section 3.17

Where the workshop stands

Phase 31, 14 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

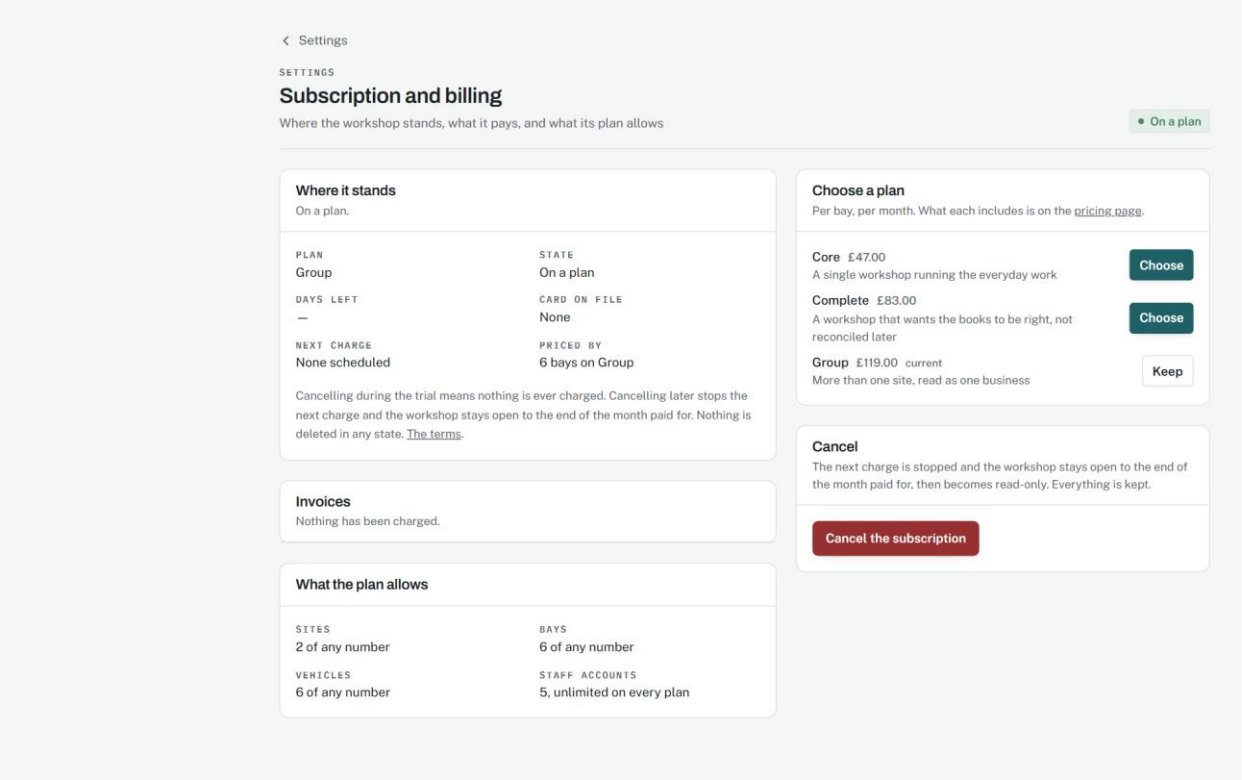
A trial ends, a plan is chosen or not, a workshop cancels. Each of these used to be a column nobody read. Now there is one page that says where the workshop stands, what its plan allows and how much of it is used, and it is also where a refused write lands, so the reason for the refusal is on the screen that can fix it.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The badge in the header is the state in two words: on trial, trial ended, on a plan, read-only, cancelled.
- The left card is the standing: plan, state, days left, and each counted thing as used-of-allowed, with "any number" where there is no ceiling.
- The right column is the two things that change the state: choose a plan, or cancel. Cancel is bordered in the danger colour and says in its own words that nothing is deleted.
- A refused write arrives with a red alert at the top: what could not be saved, and that reading and exporting still work.

WHY IT WORKS

A plan limit is refused where the thing is made, so the page is a courtesy and never the lock. The state is read from four dates each time, so the page cannot disagree with the guard that turned the write away.



The subscription page, on a plan.

Source: docs/02-design/05-security-model.md, section 3, and 04-state-machines.md, section 9

Pay now, and what became of it

Phase 32, 14 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

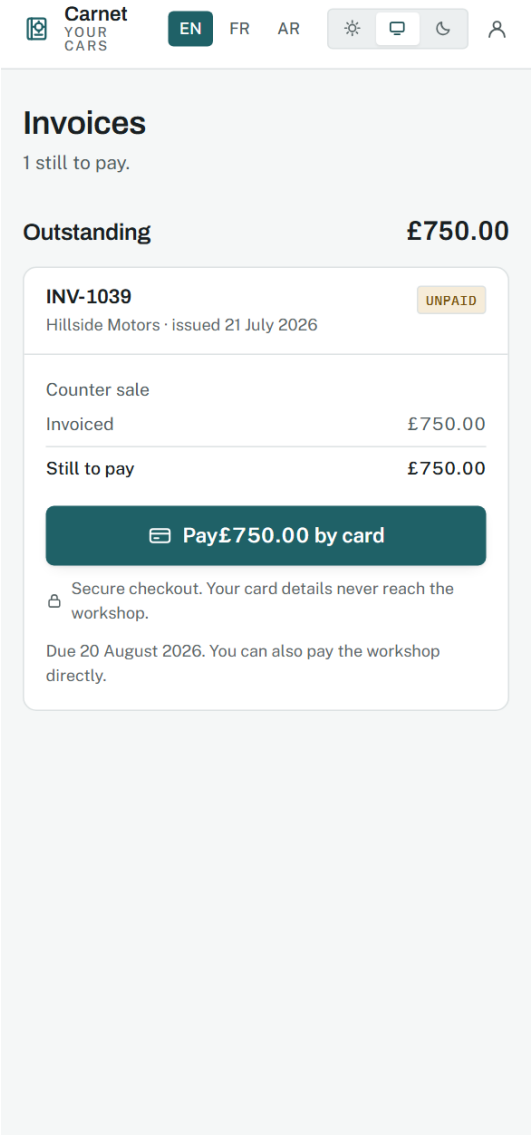
The portal used to say "pay the workshop directly". A customer on their phone at nine in the evening does not want a sort code; they want a button. The button opens the provider's checkout for exactly what is owed, and whichever way it goes the customer comes back to the same page with the outcome in a sentence.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

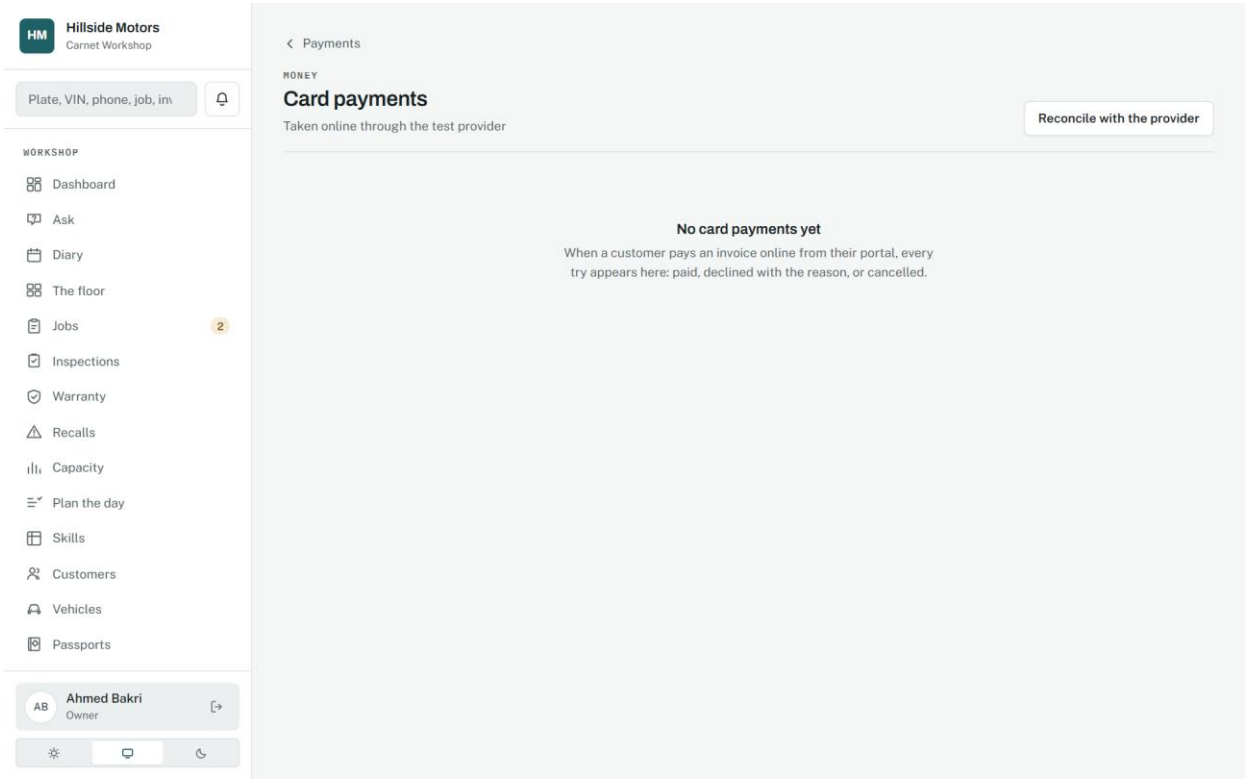
- One filled petrol button per outstanding invoice, full width, with a card icon and the amount inside it: "Pay £750.00 by card". Beneath it, a lock and the assurance that the card details never reach the workshop; paying the workshop directly stays possible.
- The outcome comes back as an alert at the top: paid and a receipt on its way; declined, with the provider's reason and the assurance that nothing was taken; cancelled; or not yet confirmed.
- The workshop's card payments page is every attempt, newest first, with a declined card kept beside its reason rather than vanishing, and a reconcile button that names each difference between the provider and the books.

WHY IT WORKS

A failed payment is a row with a reason, so the customer and the workshop see the same fact. The provider is a witness and never the record: the payment is recorded once, at the moment the attempt succeeds, and the reconcile page exists because two records can disagree and somebody has to be told.



The portal's invoices, with Pay now.



Every card payment tried, and the provider's word against the books.

Source: docs/02-design/04-state-machines.md, section 10; 07-accounting-model.md, section 3.18

The customer's side, redesigned

Phase 32.5, 14 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

The owner opened the portal on their own phone and found the navigation missing from the home page, invoices reachable only through a vehicle, a referral code sitting between the cars and the service history, and a phone layout stretched across a monitor. Each of those is a small thing; together they made the customer's side feel like an afterthought, and the customer's side is the passport's audience.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- A fixed tab bar at the bottom of the phone, five tabs with icons, on every page: Home, Passports, Invoices, Updates, Book. On a desktop the same tabs run under the header and the home becomes two columns.
- The home leads with Needs you: an estimate to decide, invoices to pay by card, a recall to book, each with its own button. Then the cars as cards with one way in, then recent work.
- Rewards are a page: points per workshop and the referral code, with the rule beside it. The home gives them one line in the side column.
- A directory of every workshop on Carnet, findable by name or place, with Book here on each; booking at a new one makes the customer its customer.

WHY IT WORKS

A person who visits twice a year should never have to learn a layout. Everything is one tap away and the first thing on the screen is the thing that needs them, with the button that finishes it.

Carnet
YOUR CARS

EN FR AR

Hello, Maria

3 things need your attention.

Add a car | Book a visit

NEEDS YOU

ESTIMATE TO APPROVE

BMW X5 · Brake system repair

Hillside Motors · estimated £1,509.00

Review and decide

INVOICE TO PAY

£750.00

INV-1039 from Hillside Motors

Pay by card

SAFETY RECALL

2020 BMW X5

The manufacturer has an open safety recall on this car. The fix is free; book it in.

Book the recall

MY CARS

2020
BMW X5
MK20 XRT

50,000 km · 108 entries on its passport

Customer approval

Open →

2021
Honda Civic
LR21 KJD

Not recorded · 0 entries on its passport

Nothing due

Open →

RECENT WORK

Brake system repair

BMW X5 · Hillside Motors · 11 Sept 2026

CUSTOMER APPROVAL

REWARDS

4,233 points

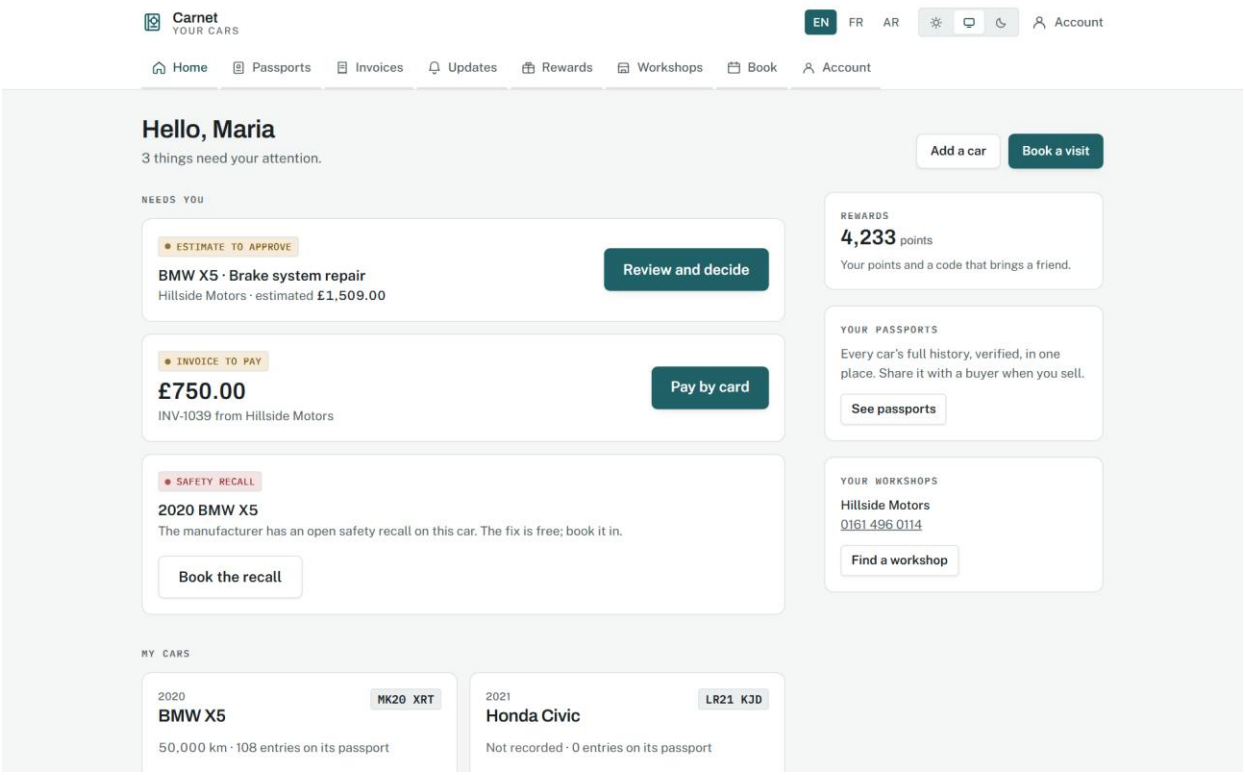
Your points and a code that brings a friend.

YOUR PASSPORTS

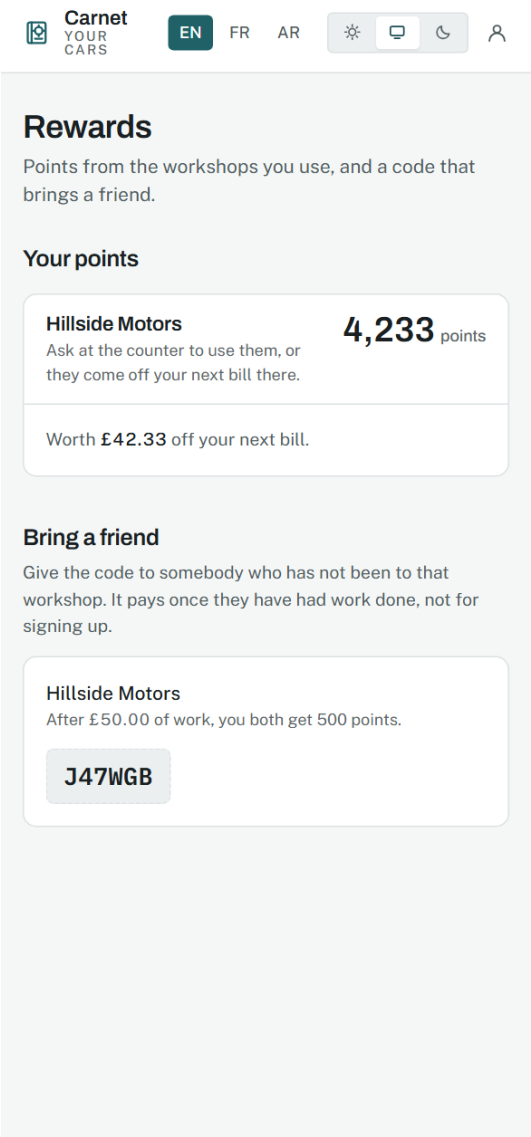
Every car's full history, verified, in one place. Share it with a buyer when you sell.

See passports

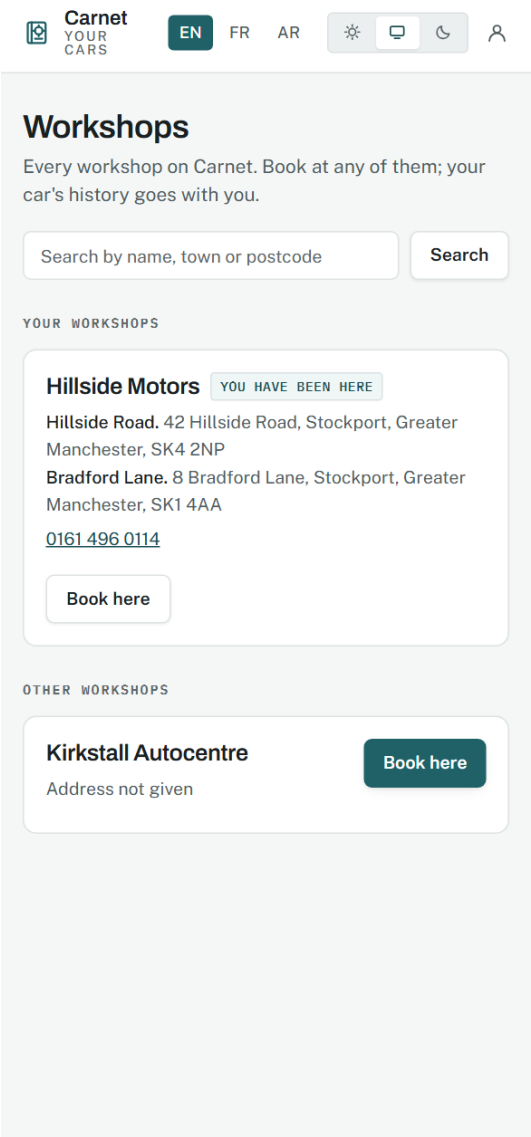
The home, on a phone.



The home, on a desktop.



Rewards, on their own page.



The workshop directory.

Source: docs/02-design/09-wireframes.md, section 11; 08-design-system.md, section 7

The charge, said before the card

Phase 32.6, 14 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

The owner asked for a trial that could not be mistaken for a trap: the card first, fourteen days, and the charge said in plain words everywhere it could be. The design problem is where to put a sentence nobody wants to read so that everybody reads it.

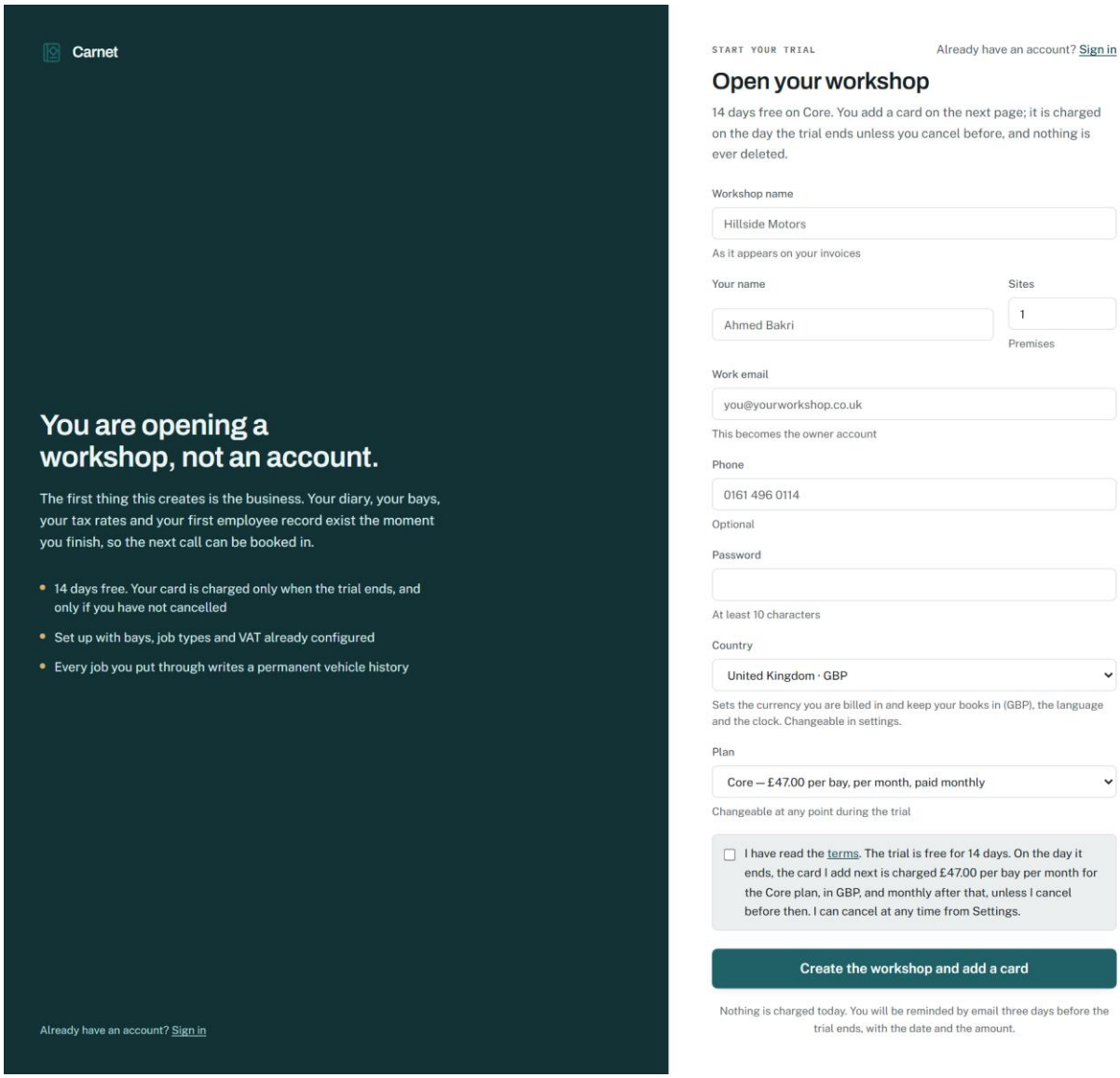
WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- On the sign-up form the terms are a box beside the button, not a footnote under it, and the box itself says the plan, the price per bay, the day the card is charged and that cancelling is two presses. The button says what happens next: create the workshop and add a card.
- The terms page leads with the same sentence in bold, then cancelling, then what happens when a payment fails, then the data. Seven short sections, no legal register.

- The billing page states the next charge as an amount on a date, the card by its last four digits, and the invoices as a table with the provider's PDF. A workshop without a card sees one button and one sentence: nothing is charged until the trial ends.

WHY IT WORKS

A sentence repeated in the same words in five places is a sentence nobody can claim not to have seen. The reminder three days before, once, is the same sentence with a date and an amount in it.



Sign-up, with the terms beside the button.

Carnet

TERMS OF SERVICE

What you agree to when you open a workshop

Version 2026-09-14.

1. The trial, and the charge that follows it

Opening a workshop starts a free trial of 14 days. To start it you add a payment card. Nothing is charged during the trial.

When the trial ends, the card is charged automatically for the first month of the plan you chose, and then every month on the same day, unless you cancel before the trial ends. We tell you this here, on the sign-up form, in the welcome email, and again by email 3 days before the trial ends, with the date and the amount.

The plans and their prices are on the pricing page, per bay, per month, and exclude tax. You are billed in the currency of your country, the one your books are kept in, and in no other. Paid monthly, per bay per month, the plans cost:

CURRENCY	CORE	COMPLETE	GROUP
GBP	£47.00	£83.00	£119.00
EUR	€55.00	€95.00	€139.00
USD	$59.00	$105.00	$149.00
CAD	CA$79.00	CA$145.00	CA$199.00
AUD	A$89.00	A$159.00	A$225.00
NZD	NZ$95.00	NZ$169.00	NZ$239.00
AED	AED 219.00	AED 379.00	AED 549.00
SAR	SAR 225.00	SAR 389.00	SAR 559.00
ZAR	ZAR 1,079.00	ZAR 1,899.00	ZAR 2,749.00
INR	₹4,799.00	₹8,399.00	₹11,999.00
EGP	EGP 2,890.00	EGP 4,990.00	EGP 7,190.00

The amount you will be charged, the price times your bays, is shown on your billing page before the trial ends.

2. Cancelling

You can cancel at any time from Settings, Subscription, in two presses, with no call and no notice period. Cancelling during the trial means nothing is ever charged. Cancelling after that stops the next charge; the workshop stays open until the end of the month you have paid for, then becomes read-only.

We do not refund a month already started, except where the law where you are requires it or where the service was not available for a material part of that month.

3. If a payment fails

If a charge fails, we tell you by email and the provider tries again over the following days. The workshop keeps working while that happens. If no payment succeeds within 14 days, the workshop becomes read-only until a payment goes through. Nothing is deleted.

4. Your data

Everything you enter is yours. A read-only or cancelled workshop can still read all of it and export all of it. We do not delete a workshop's data when it stops paying; we delete it when you ask us to, subject to the retention the law requires for invoices and tax records.

The vehicle passport is different by design: an entry a workshop writes to a vehicle's history belongs to the vehicle's record and stays readable to the vehicle's owner after the workshop leaves Carnet. Nothing in it identifies a workshop's customers to anybody else.

5. Card payments from your customers

When your customers pay an invoice by card through Carnet, the payment is processed by our payment provider. Card details never reach Carnet or you. The provider's fees for those payments are shown on your billing page and on the provider's statement.

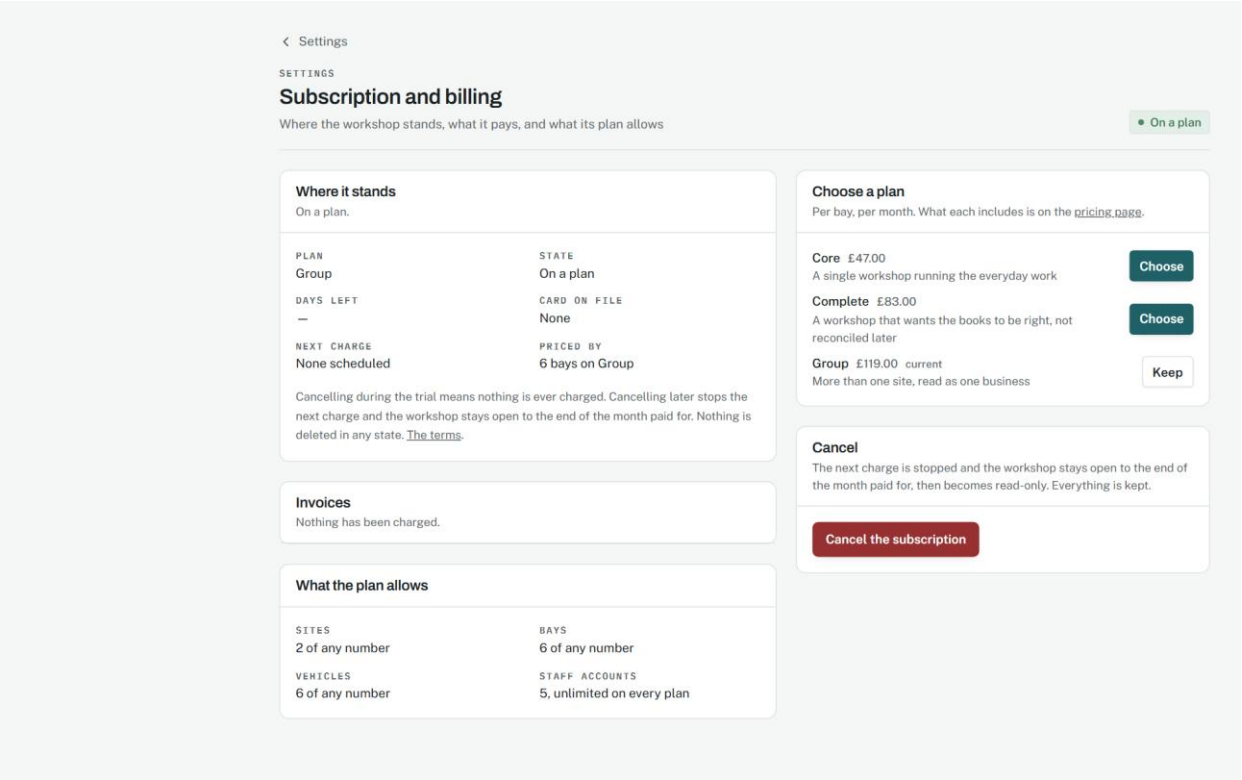
6. Changes

If we change a price or these terms in a way that matters, we tell you by email at least 30 days before it applies, and you can cancel before then. The version you accepted is recorded on your account.

7. Who we are

Carnet is operated by Carnet Software. Questions about these terms or a charge go to the support address on the pricing page, and we answer them.

The terms, in plain words.



The billing page: card, next charge, invoices.

Source: docs/02-design/04-state-machines.md, section 9; 05-security-model.md, section 7.2

Priced in the workshop's money, and the customer's account

Phase 32.7, 14 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

The owner put it in one sentence: everything in one currency based on the country, not shown in pounds and billed in another. And a customer looking for settings in the portal found none.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The pricing page takes a country and shows every plan in that currency, with the tax named the way that country names it. No second currency appears anywhere on the page.
- On the sign-up form, changing the country changes the plan's prices and the sentence beside the terms box in the same breath; they are one component.
- The customer's Account page: details the workshops know them by, a password change that asks for the current one, a row per workshop with email and text switches, and sign out. A tab on the desktop, a person icon in the header on a phone.

WHY IT WORKS

One currency per page removes a whole class of doubt. A price book set by hand, rather than a rate on the day, means the number a workshop saw on Tuesday is the number it is charged on Friday.

PRICING

Per bay, per month, published in full

Priced per bay, because bays are what a workshop earns from. Staff accounts are unlimited on every plan: charging per user would bill you for giving your own people access.

Annual Monthly

Prices in the currency of Canada · CAD Show

Core

A single workshop running the everyday work

$69.00 per bay, per month

Billed annually. Saves 13% against $79.00 monthly.

Start 14-day trial

- Diary, jobs, inspections and estimates
- Vehicle passport on every car you touch
- Invoicing, payments and parts
- Customer portal

Complete

MOST CHOSEN

A workshop that wants the books to be right, not reconciled later

$119.00 per bay, per month

Billed annually. Saves 18% against $145.00 monthly.

Start 14-day trial

- Everything in Core
- Double-entry ledger, posted from the work itself
- Profit and loss, balance sheet, VAT position
- Purchase orders and three-way bill matching
- Timesheets, pay history and commission

Group

More than one site, read as one business

$169.00 per bay, per month

Billed annually. Saves 15% against $199.00 monthly.

Start 14-day trial

- Everything in Complete, at every site
- Consolidated reporting that carries its spread
- Stock transfers, with what is on the road counted
- Per-site permissions and single sign-on

Prices are in CAD, per bay per month, and exclude GST 5%. You are billed in the currency of your country and no other. The trial creates a real workshop with your data in it. A card is added at sign-up and charged only when the trial ends, unless you cancel first.

COMPARE

What each plan actually includes

Limits are counted and enforced. When a workshop reaches one, the system says so before it stops rather than after.

LIMITS	Core	Complete	Group
Bays	6	24	No limit
Sites	1	1	No limit
Staff accounts	No limit	No limit	No limit
Vehicles on the books	5,000	40,000	No limit
FEATURES			
The vehicle passport	✓	✓	✓
Digital inspections	✓	✓	✓
Estimates and approvals	✓	✓	✓
The parts catalogue	✓	✓	✓
Purchase orders	–	✓	✓
The general ledger	–	✓	✓
Financial statements	–	✓	✓
Timesheets and payroll	–	✓	✓
Commission schemes	–	✓	✓
More than one site	–	–	✓
Stock transfers between sites	–	–	✓
The API	–	✓	✓
Single sign-on	–	–	✓

The pricing page, in Canadian dollars.

Carnet YOUR CARS EN FR AR

Account

Your details, how you sign in, and what each workshop may send you.

Your details

Your email is how you sign in and where receipts and updates go.

Name

Maria Okonkwo

Email

maria@example.test

Confirmed. To change it, get in touch with a workshop you use.

Mobile

For text messages about your car, if you allow them below

Save details

Password

At least 10 characters.

Current password

New password

Change password

Forgotten it? Reset it by email.

What each workshop may send you

Messages about your own car and its bookings always come. This is about offers and reminders beyond that.

Hillside Motors

- [x] Email offers and reminders
- [x] Text messages

Save

Money and rewards

Invoices and payments

Points and referral code

Sign out

On a shared phone or a garage's computer, sign out when you are done.

Sign out

The customer's account page.

Source: docs/00-product/07-business-model.md; 08-design-system.md, section 12.6

Data in, data out

Phase 33, 14 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

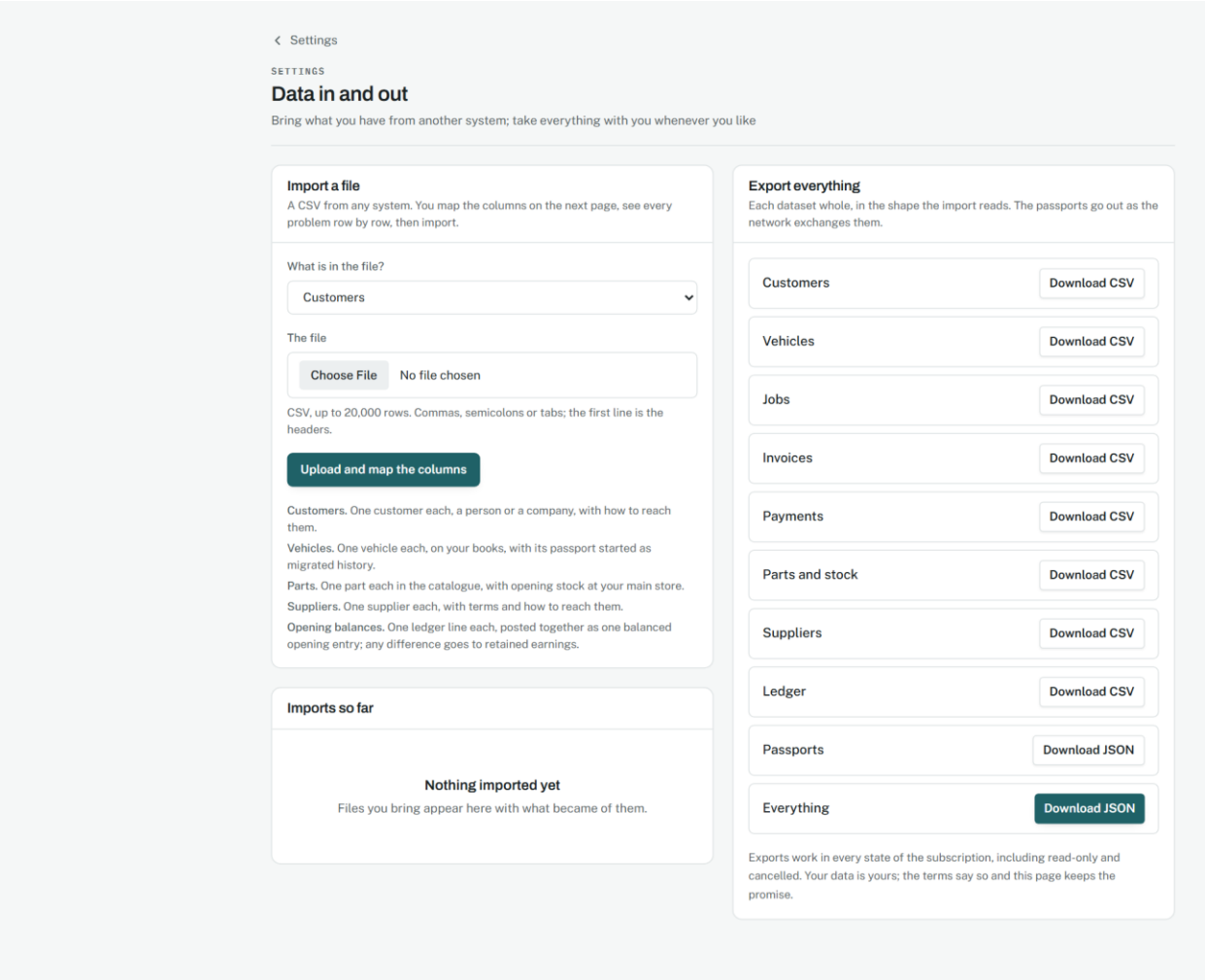
A workshop arriving with five thousand customers in another system, and a workshop leaving with everything: both are one page, because both are the same promise, that the data is theirs.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The import card leads: what is in the file, the file, one button. Beneath it, one line per dataset saying what a row becomes.
- On the batch page the three steps sit side by side: which column is which, with the first rows shown beside each header; what would go in, with every problem by spreadsheet row and field; then one button naming the count.
- The export card is the datasets as a list with a download on each and Everything as the primary, and a sentence saying exports work in every state of the subscription.

WHY IT WORKS

Problems named by row and field are problems a person can fix in the spreadsheet they already have open. Writing every row through the page's own function means the import cannot do anything the page could not.



Data in and out.

Source: docs/02-design/01-domain-model.md, section 3.11; 05-security-model.md, section 7.3

The workflow, as one thing

Phase 34, 15 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

A workshop does not buy features; it buys the number of presses between a car arriving and the money being in the bank. This phase counted them, wrote the count down, and then took it from 37 to 20.

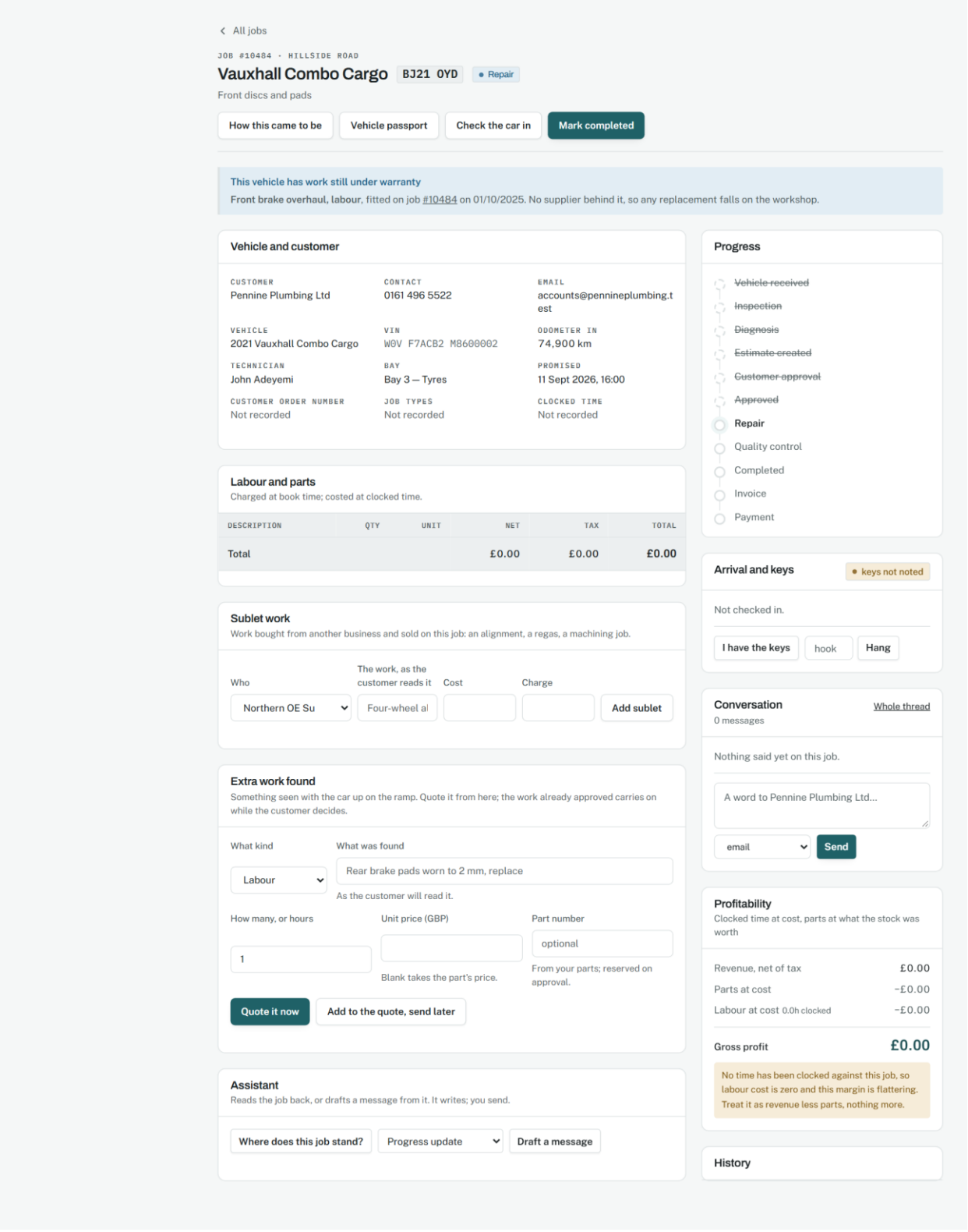
WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- On the booking, one primary button: "Car is here, start the job". It opens the job with the customer, the car, the description, the notes and the technician already on it; the two secondary buttons either side are the telephone's other answers.
- On the job, "Customer approved in person" sits beside "Send the quote" for as long as the quote is open, because a yes across the counter is as real as a yes on a phone and must cost one press to record.
- Below the labour and parts, a card called Extra work found: what kind, what was found, how many, at what price, which part. Two buttons: "Quote it now" sends in the same press; "Add to the quote, send later" collects lines. What is on the unsent quote is listed above the form with its own send and approve, so nothing about the extra work leaves this screen.

- The five workflows are a table in core with a press count per hand-off, before and now, and the screen it happens on; the design document 02-design/11-workflows.md is generated from it.

WHY IT WORKS

A hand-off that costs nothing is one the system did on the person's behalf: the approval that puts the lines on the job and reserves the parts. Counting presses in code, with a test that fails if any grow, is what stops a 94-page product from becoming slower than a spreadsheet and a phone.



The job, with the extra-work card and the counter approval.

Arrival and departure

Phase 35, 15 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

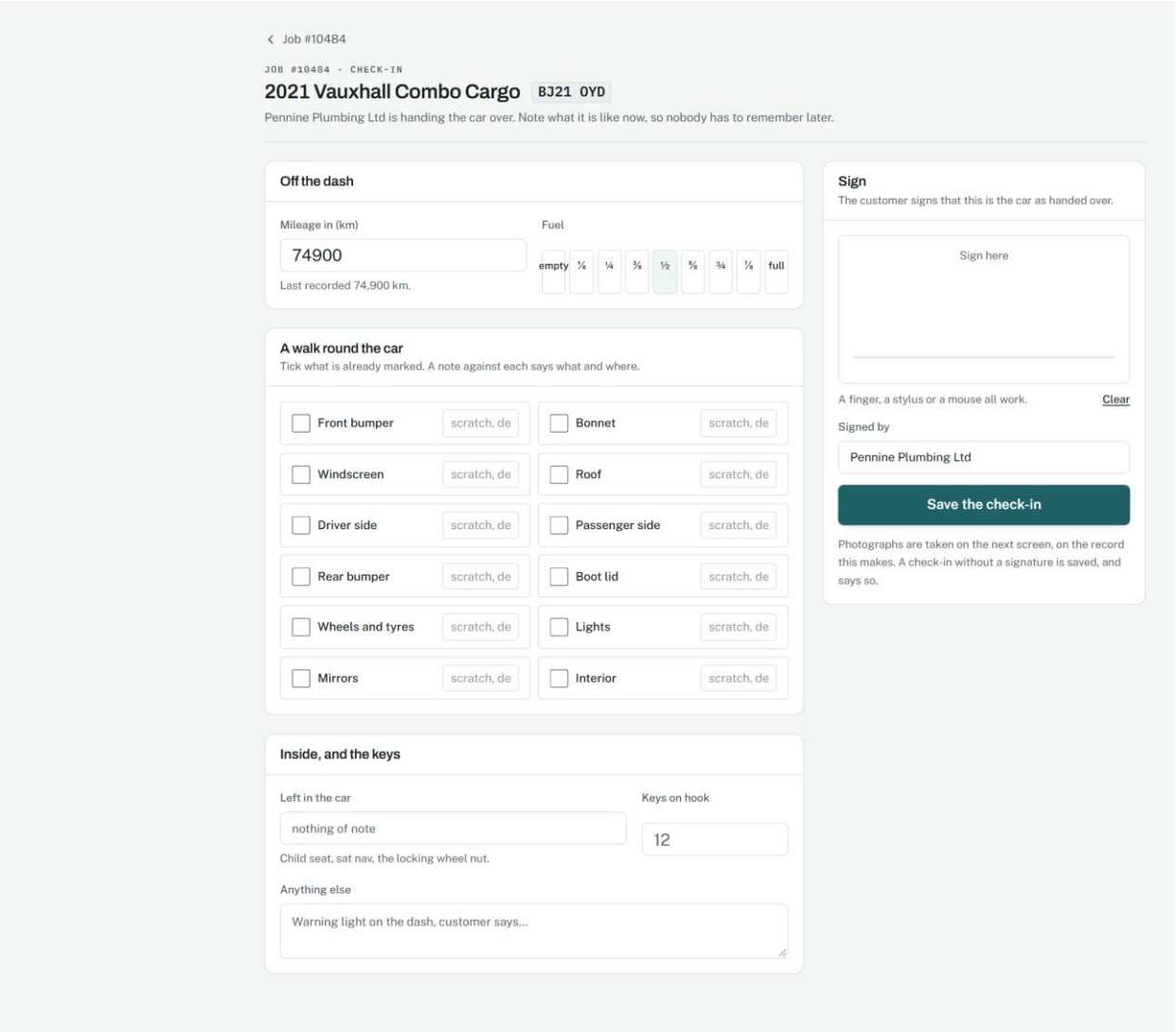
Most of what a workshop is ever argued with about is settled by what the car was like when it was handed over and when it was handed back. Those two moments are a record of their own, signed.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The check-in is one screen filled in with the customer standing there: the mileage off the dash, the fuel as nine buttons in eighths, a walk round the car as twelve places to tick with a note against each, what was left inside, the hook, and a signature pad in the sidebar with one button under it.
- Saving makes the record and shows it, with the camera button on it, because a walk round a car is six pictures and they belong to the record, not to a form.
- The check-out puts the money before the mileage: what is outstanding, a primary button to take the payment, and a field to say why the car is leaving unpaid if it is. The hand-back button is disabled until the work is marked completed and the page says so in a sentence.
- Keys are a sentence on the job and on the technician's card, with the one press each needs: I have them; back on the hook.

WHY IT WORKS

A signature kept as strokes is a few hundred bytes, redraws at any size and cannot be a pasted picture. Refusing a car that is leaving owing money unless somebody writes down why turns a habit into a record.



Checking a car in.

Source: docs/02-design/01-domain-model.md, section 3.13; 05-security-model.md, section 7.4

Conversations

Phase 36, 15 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

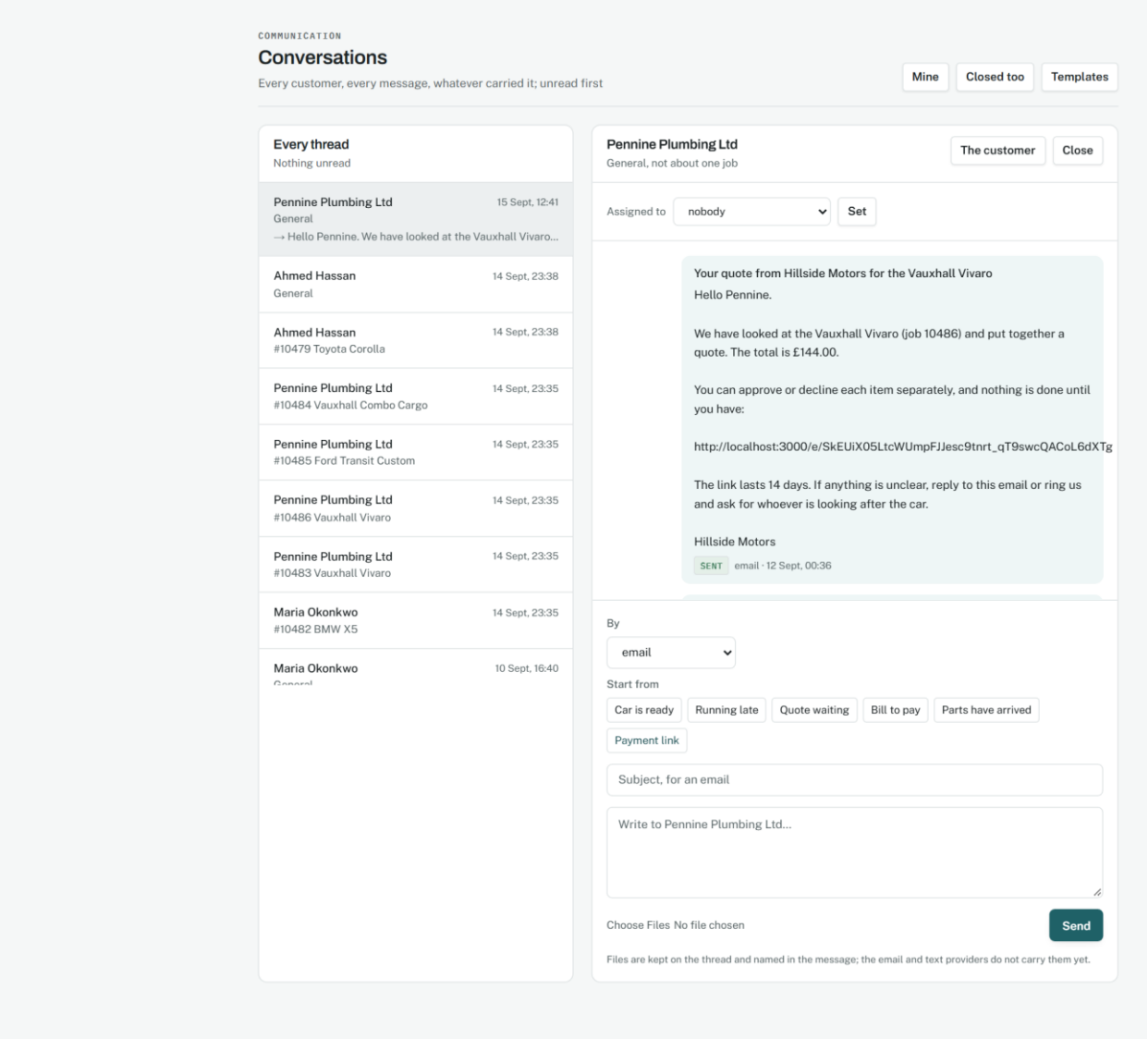
A customer does not think in channels. They asked a question; the workshop answered or did not. Everything said to and by a customer belongs in one place, on the job it is about.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The list on the left is unread first, a dot and a bold name for what needs reading, the last line as a preview with an arrow for its direction, and the job it is about under the name.
- The thread on the right reads oldest to newest, sent on the right in the brand tint and received on the left in a bordered card, each with a one-word state, the channel, the time and who wrote it.
- The composer offers only the channels the customer can be reached on, the one they last wrote on first. Templates are chips that fill the box with a sentence; Payment link is a chip in the brand colour.
- On the job, the same thread as a card: the last three messages and a reply box, so nobody leaves the job to answer.

WHY IT WORKS

A thread that is a view over the two message tables rather than a third one keeps the queue and the inbox honest; unread derived from dates rather than a flag cannot drift; refusing a template with a blank is the difference between a workshop's name under a good message and under an embarrassing one.



Conversations, with a thread open.

Source: docs/02-design/01-domain-model.md, section 3.14; 06-api-contract.md, inbound

---

Packages and templates

Phase 37, 15 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

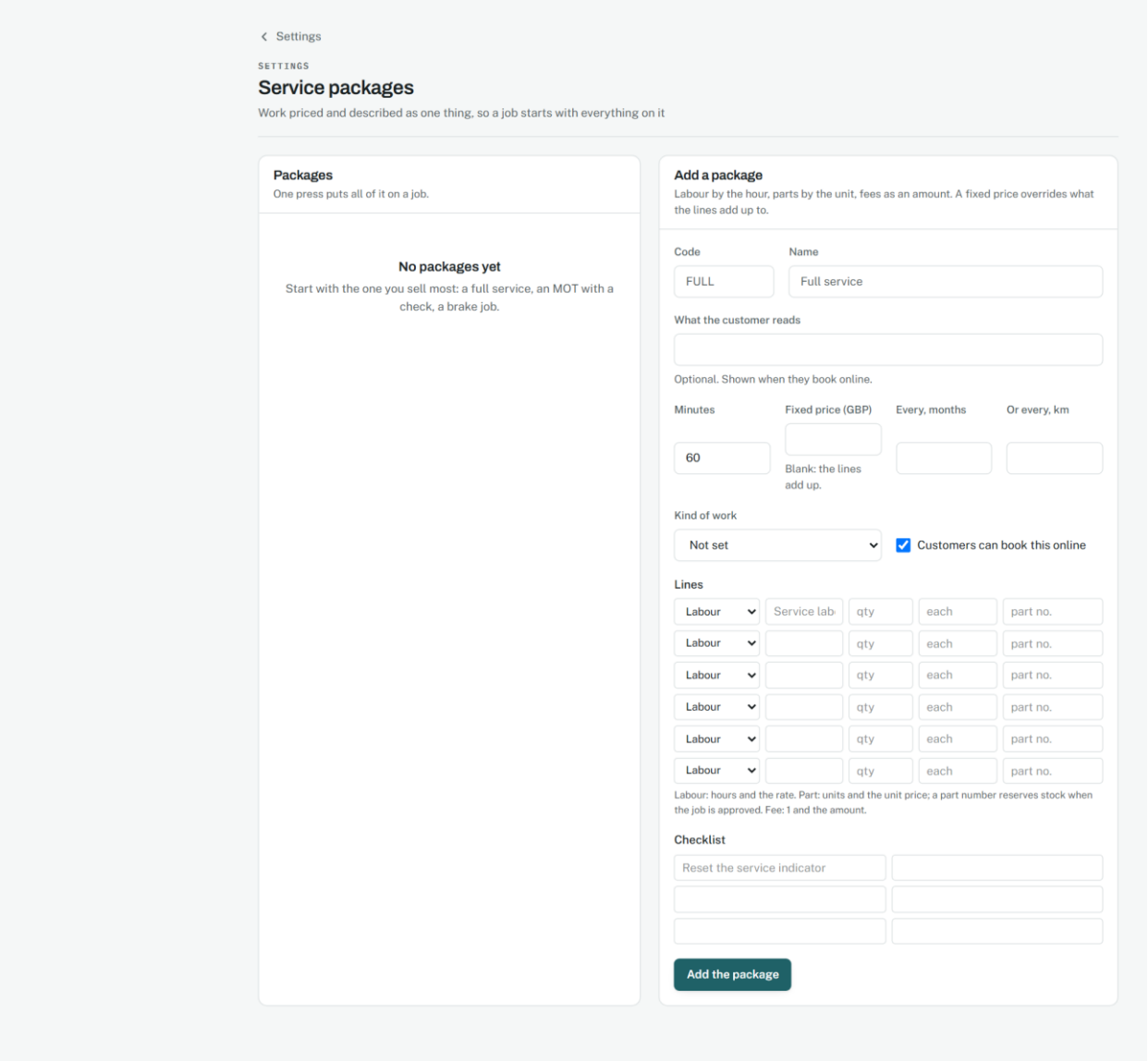
"Full service" typed at the counter is a job nobody can pick up without asking. A package is the same words with the labour, the parts, the checklist, the time and the price already decided.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The settings page is the list on the left and the editor on the right. Each package is one line: code, name, price with the saving if the fixed price undercuts the lines, hours, how many lines and checks, the kind of work, the interval, whether it is bookable.
- The editor is six line rows (kind, description, quantity, each, part number) and six checklist rows, because a package with more than that is two packages. A fixed price is one field; blank means the lines add up.
- On the new-job form the package is the first question; choosing one fills the description. On the job, the labour and parts card offers a package and one button. The booking form and the customer's online booking offer the same list.

WHY IT WORKS

Saved whole, a package is never half of one. Recording which package a job came from is what lets completion say when the next one is due, which is the reminder that brings the customer back.



Service packages.

Source: docs/02-design/01-domain-model.md, section 3.15

Languages

Phase 37.5, 15 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

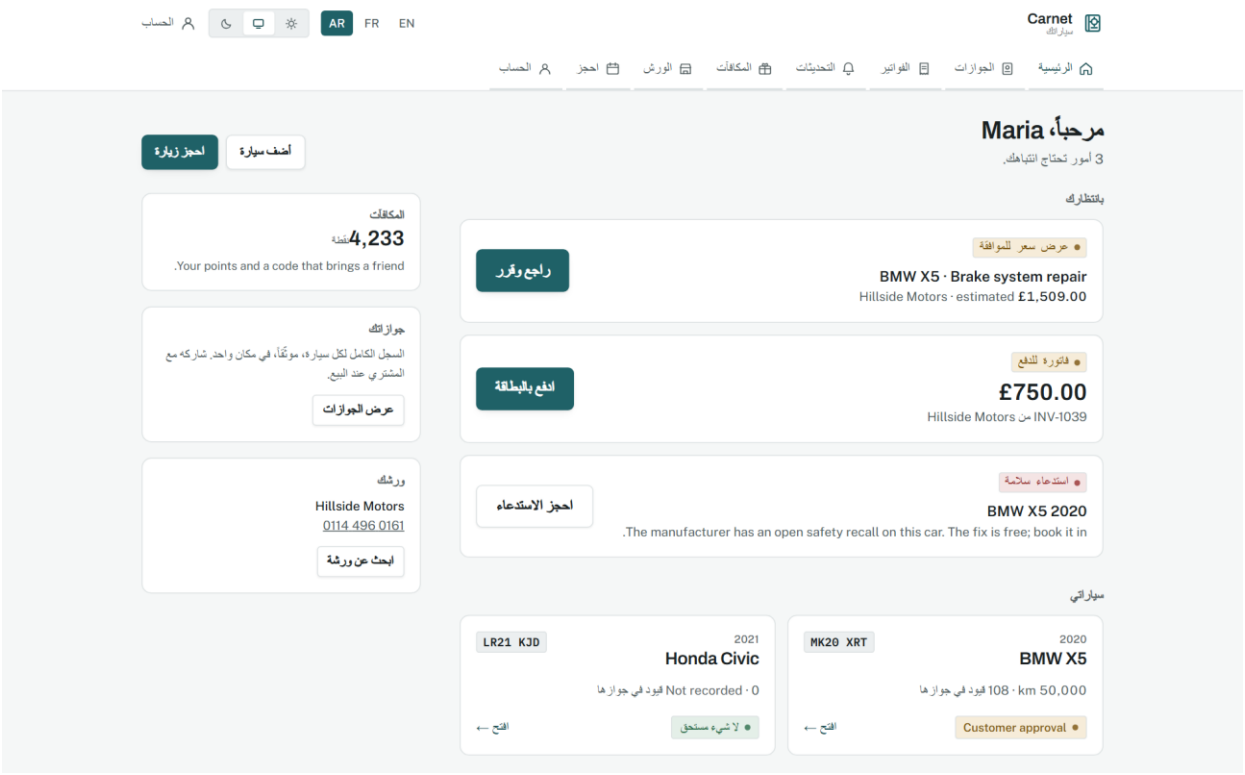
A customer in Cairo and a workshop in Lyon should each read Carnet in their own language, chosen once and kept. Arabic reads right to left, and the page has to follow.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

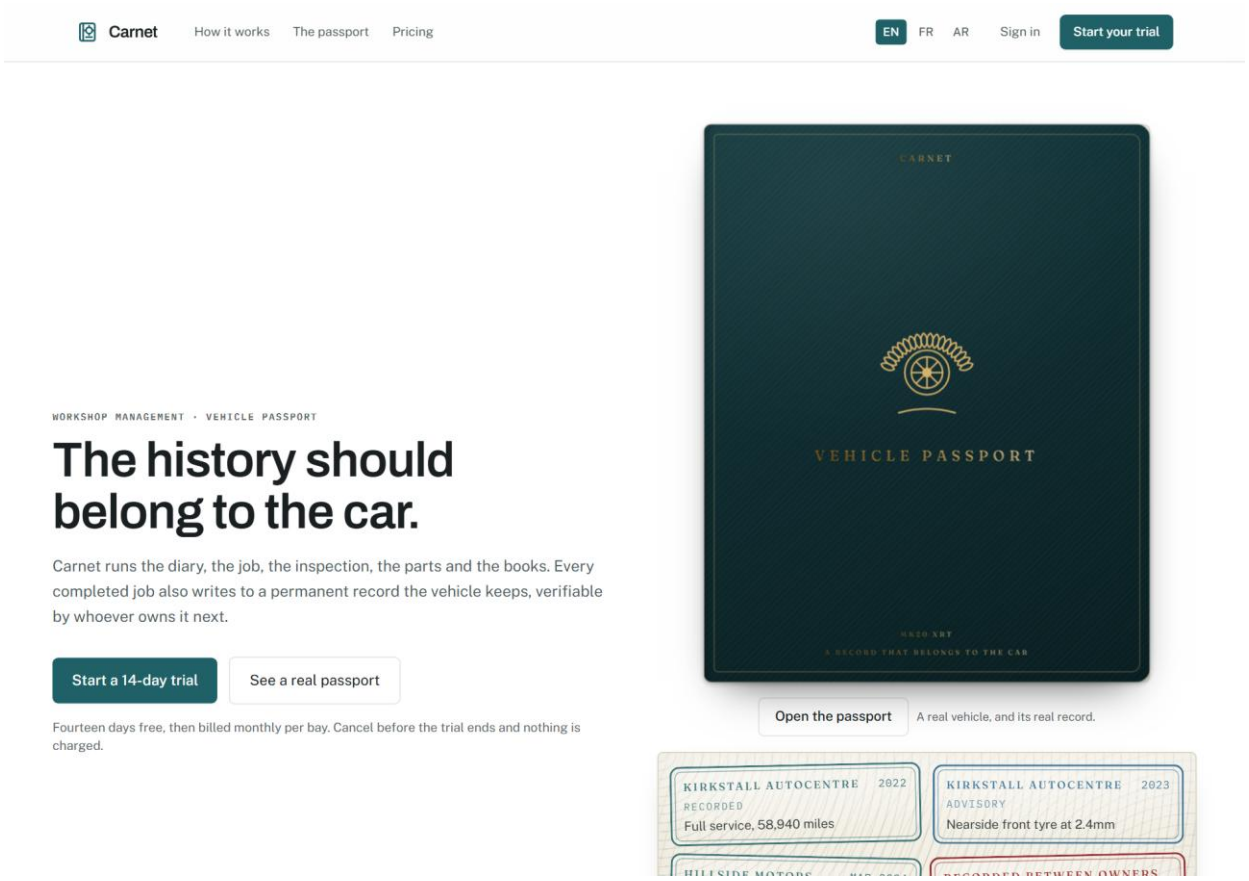
- The switcher is three buttons, the current one filled in the brand colour: EN, FR, AR in the headers, the full names where there is room.
- The whole page turns with the language: the root element carries the direction, and a layout built on flex and grid with logical order reads right to left without a second stylesheet.
- English is the source of truth. A sentence without a translation is shown in English rather than as a key or a blank, and the coverage script names it.

WHY IT WORKS

Keeping the English sentence as the key means a page is translated by wrapping what is already there, and the dictionary reads as a list of sentences a person can check.



The customer's portal in Arabic, right to left.



The home page in French.

Source: docs/02-design/08-design-system.md, section 12.7

Parts back, work out

Phase 38, 15 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

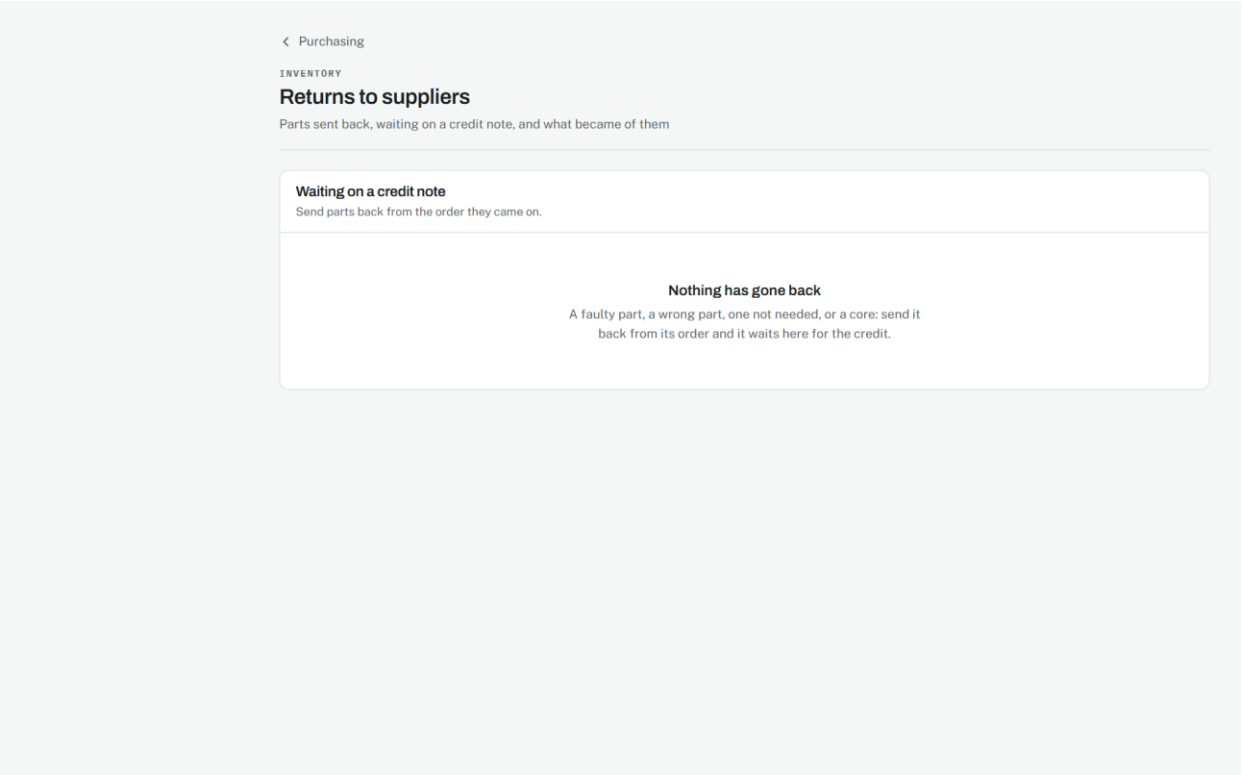
A faulty part that goes back without a record is a part paid for twice; an alignment bought in and not written down is work given away. Both belong where the money already is.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- On the order, a card called Send parts back: which part, how many, why, a core charge for a core, a note. One secondary button, because sending parts back is not the order's main business.
- The returns page leads with what is waiting on a credit note, each with two forms side by side: the credit note (number, net, tax, and a primary button) and the refusal (the reason, and a secondary one).
- On the job, Sublet work lists each piece with its vendor, cost, charge and margin, red when it is sold below cost, and the two presses it needs: the work is back, and book their bill.

WHY IT WORKS

Taking the cost off the shelf the moment the part leaves, and holding it as a credit due, means stock, the ledger and the supplier's account agree on every day between the part going and the credit arriving.



Returns to suppliers.

Source: docs/02-design/07-accounting-model.md, Returns, cores and sublet

---

Finding anything

Phase 39, 15 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

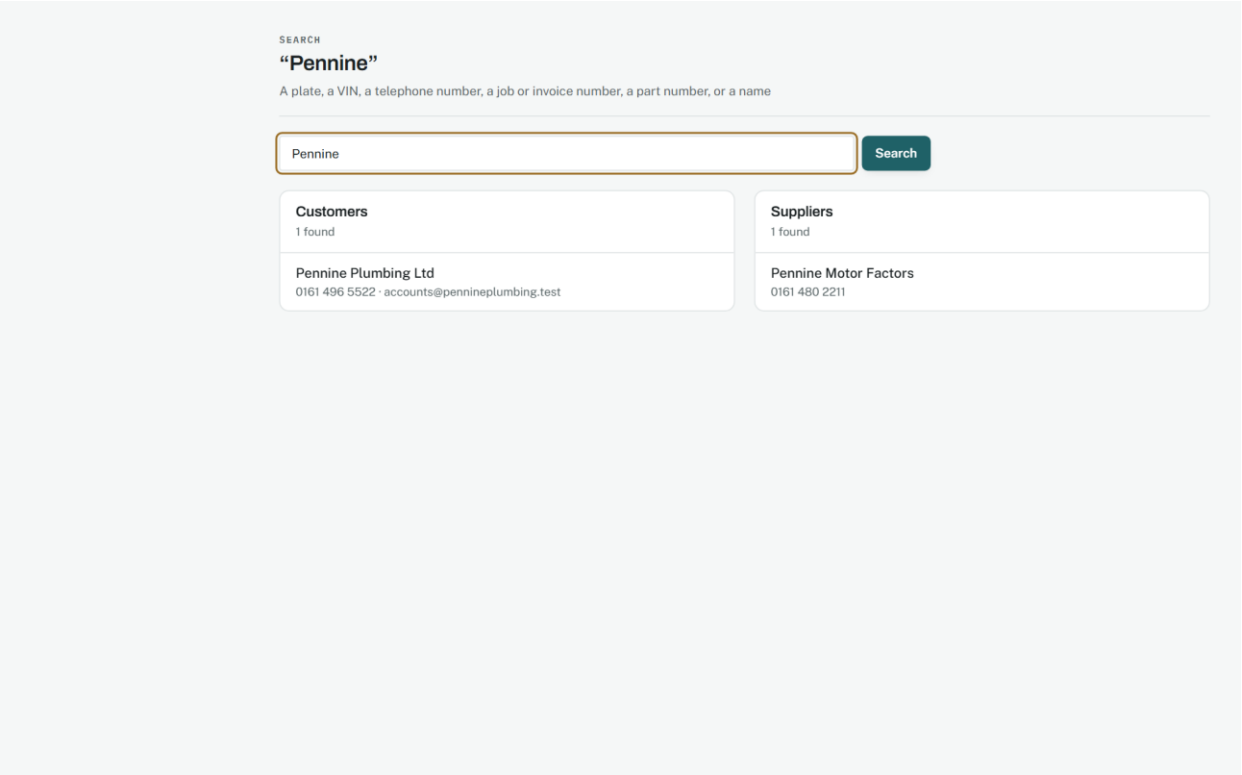
A caller reads out a plate, a number, an invoice. The person at the desk should be looking at the record before they finish the sentence, from whatever page they are on.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

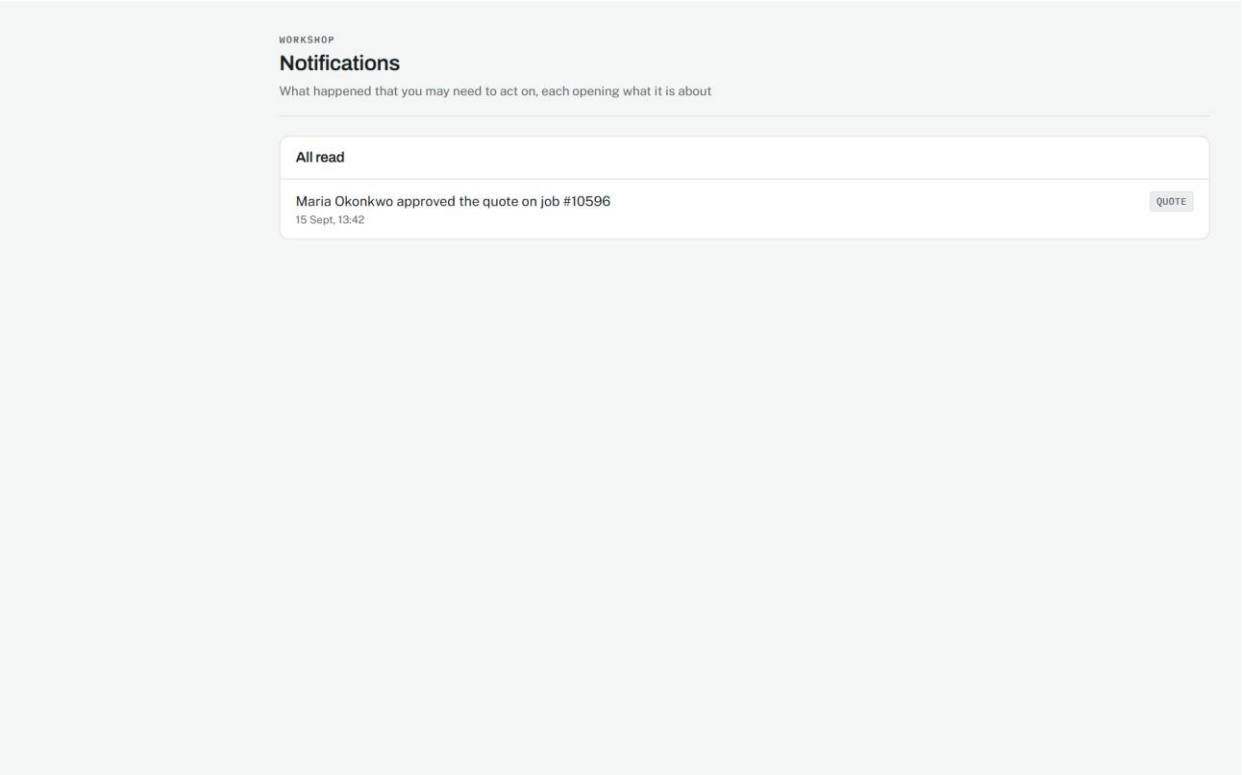
- The box sits at the top of the navigation, under the workshop's name, on every page, with the bell beside it carrying the unread count in red.
- An exact identifier opens its record with no page between. A name gives a grid of cards by kind, vehicles and jobs first, with exact matches badged.
- Notifications are a single list, unread rows tinted and bold, each with its kind as a small badge and one press to open what it is about.

WHY IT WORKS

Going straight to the one record saves the press that a list of one would cost, which is most searches at a counter. Telling only the people whose role acts on something keeps the bell worth looking at.



Search results for a name.



Notifications.

Source: docs/02-design/05-security-model.md, section 7.5

The owner's day, sharpened

Phase 40, 15 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

An owner asks four things the product could answer and did not: how much of the work comes back and whose, whether customers are happier and where, who to ring for a part that has run out, and which supplier has got slower.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The dashboard reads in three blocks under small headings: today, the business, inventory. Every tile is a figure that opens its list; none is a word.
- Comebacks sit on the business report in three columns, by site, by person, and what came back, with the count shown instead of a percentage until ten jobs stand behind it.
- Reputation gains a strip of six months, each with its average or a dash and the number of answers, and a list by site and by person with a small badge for improving, falling or steady.
- On a part, every supplier sits in one table with small badges for cheapest, quickest and most reliable, and an Order button that is primary when the part is short.

WHY IT WORKS

Refusing to state a rate or an average on too little keeps the figures fair to the people they name. Laying suppliers side by side, and leaving the choice to the person, fits how parts are really bought: the cheapest is not always the one that arrives by four o'clock.

TUESDAY, 15 SEPTEMBER 2026

Good afternoon, Ahmed

Open diary | New job

TODAY

JOBS TODAY	VEHICLES IN SHOP	AWAITING APPROVAL	TAKEN TODAY
0	3	2	£0.00
Created since midnight	Physically on site	Work is blocked	Payments received

PAST THE PROMISE	BOOKED TODAY	ON THE CLOCK
3	0	0
Due back and not finished	Appointments in the diary	Clocked on to a job now

Approvals needed

Nothing can proceed on these until the customer decides.

See all

BMW X5 `MK20 XRT` #10482
Maria Okonkwo · Brake system repair · waiting 99h
£1,509.00 Review

Vauxhall Vivaro `BX70 KHT` #10483
Pennine Plumbing Ltd · Clutch judder under load
Review

Today in the workshop

0 bookings scheduled

Diary

Nothing booked today

An empty diary is as much of a problem as a full one.

Add a booking

THE BUSINESS

OWED TO YOU	OVERDUE	COMEBACKS	SATISFACTION
£2,401.20	£2,034.00	0	—
Issued and not yet paid	2 invoices past their due date	Back out of 1 finished in 90 days, too few for a rate	Too few answers to compare

This month

Arithmetic with a sentence around it, from the same figures as the reports.

Ask a question

£237 invoiced in September 2026 across 1 job, £237 a job.

Gross margin 48%.

INVENTORY

SHORT	ORDERS LATE	WAITING FOR PARTS	STOCK VALUE
4	0	0	£1,737.30
Below reorder point, nothing on order	Past the day the supplier promised	Approved, and nothing on the shelf	On the shelf at average cost

Short now

Each opens the part, with every supplier side by side.

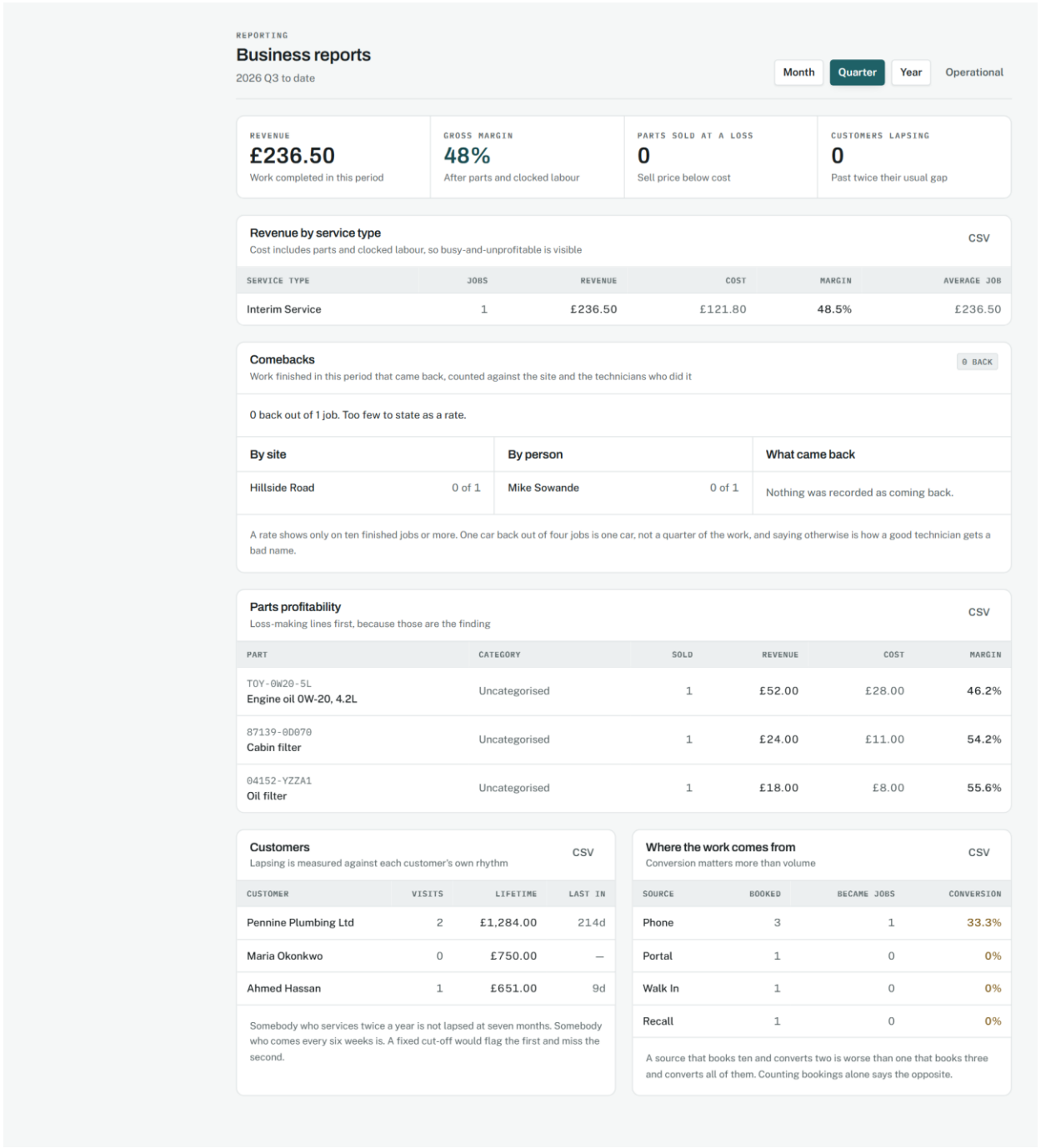
Brake fluid DOT 4, 1L BRK-FLUID-1L	-2 available, reorder at 10
Oil filter 04152-YZZA1	5 available, reorder at 12
BMW front brake discs (pair) 34116864059	0 available, reorder at 4
Battery 90Ah AGM BAT-090-AGM	0 available, reorder at 2

What's happening

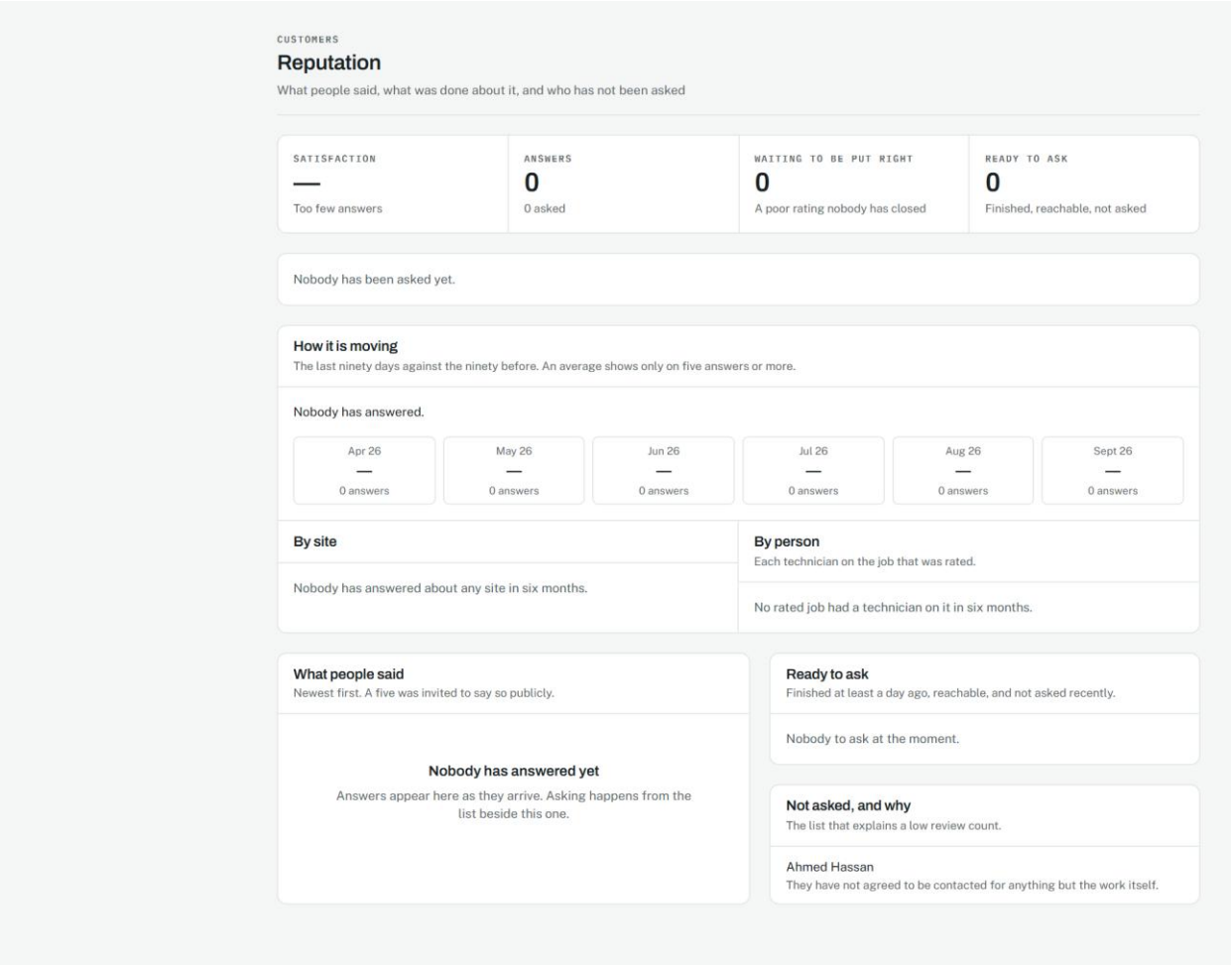
Everything the workshop has done, newest first.

Ahmed Bakri assistant exchange organization	13:47
Ahmed Bakri referral issued customer	13:44
Ahmed Bakri referral issued customer	13:43
Ahmed Bakri package reactivated servicepackage	13:42
Ahmed Bakri package retired servicepackage	13:42
Ahmed Bakri job completed job	13:42
Ahmed Bakri job in progress job	13:42
Ahmed Bakri booking converted booking	13:42
Ahmed Bakri job created job	13:42
Ahmed Bakri booking created booking	13:42

The dashboard in three blocks.



Comebacks on the business report.



How reputation is moving.

Source: docs/00-product/06-roadmap.md, Phase 40

---

11. The counter

One form, one screen

Phase 4.7, 9 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

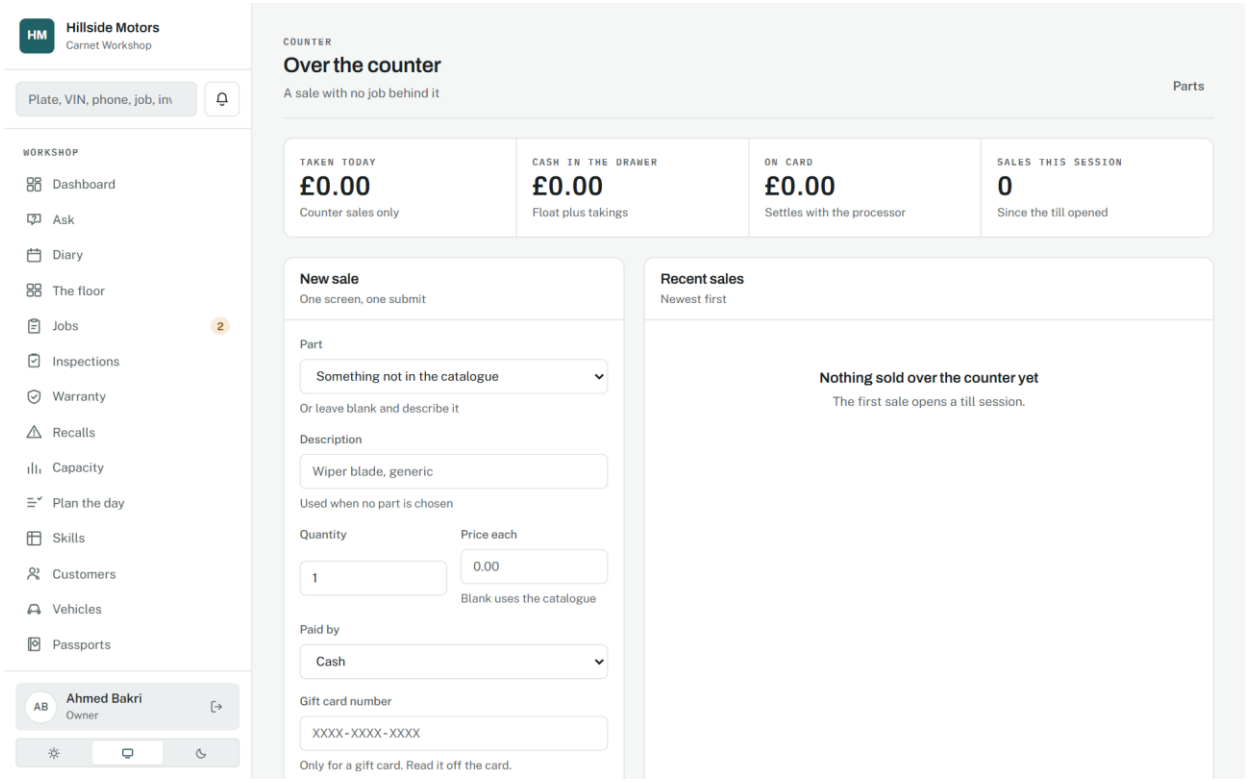
Somebody wants a bulb and there are two people behind them. The whole sale is one form: pick the part, say how it was paid, done. The stock leaves the shelf and the ledger is posted as part of that one submit, and the money lands in a till session that has to reconcile at the end of the day.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- Cash can be over-tendered and change is worked out; a card is always the exact amount.
- The till's expected drawer is derived from the sales, and closing it asks for the count.

WHY IT WORKS

There is no draft and no basket, because a counter queue is not a service desk.



The counter.

Source: docs/00-product/06-roadmap.md, Phase 4.7

---

12. Gift cards

A liability that leads the page

Phase 26, 14 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

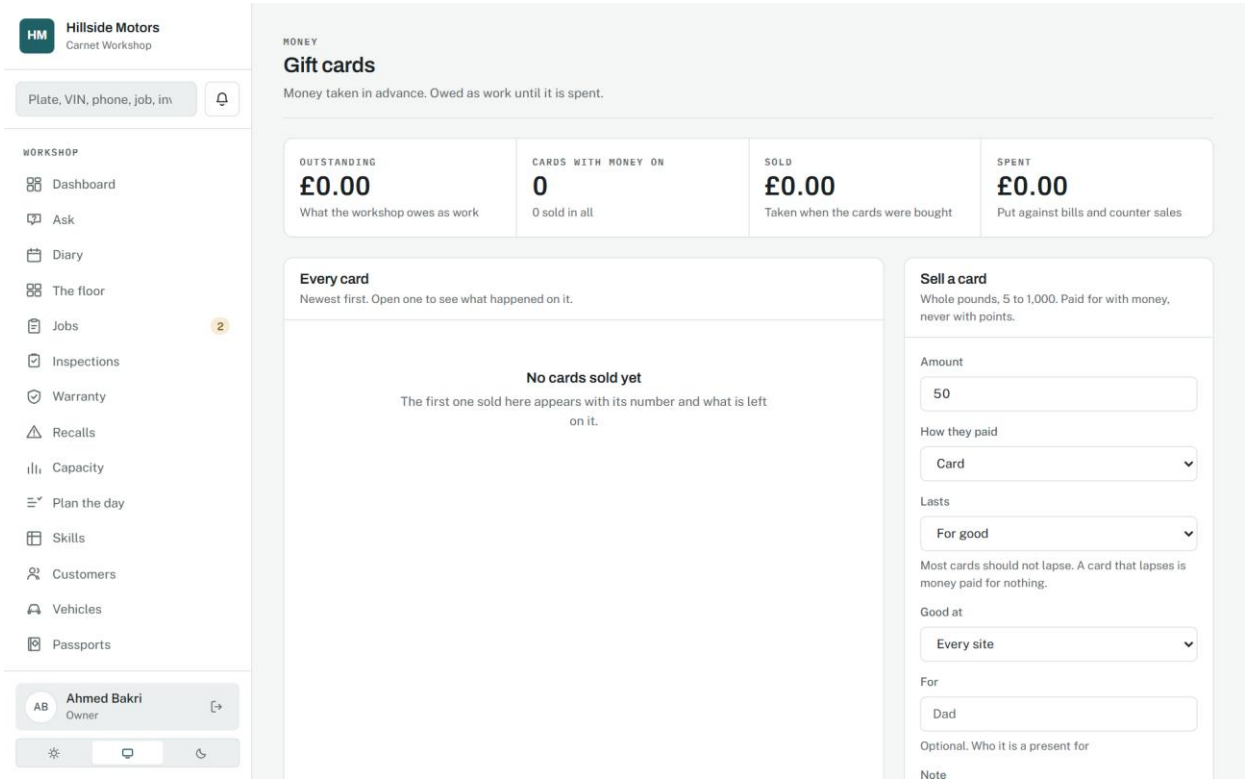
Two things go wrong with gift cards and both are accounting: the sale is booked as revenue, which flatters December and starves the month the work is done, or the redemption is booked as money in and the bank shows the same fifty pounds twice. The page leads with what the workshop owes as work, because that is what a gift card is.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The number is twelve characters from an alphabet with nothing that gets misheard, read in groups of four.
- The balance is the sum of the card's entries, each naming what it was for.
- Sold for whole pounds, paid for with money, never with points or another card.

WHY IT WORKS

A card redeemed on an invoice releases the liability and never touches the bank; a bill settled with a card still earns points, because the card was paid for with real money.



Gift cards.

Source: docs/02-design/09-wireframes.md, section 10; docs/02-design/07-accounting-model.md, 3.14 and 3.15

---

13. The customer

One screen for the person on the phone

Phase 1, 9 September 2026; the whole story in Phase 9; points and referrals in Phases 24 and 25, 13 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

A service advisor with a customer on the phone should not have to navigate away. Contact, vehicles, jobs, invoices, payments, preferences, points, referrals and the whole story are on one page, newest first.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The Points card shows the balance as the sum of the entries, what it is worth, what lapses, and a form for the points a rule cannot see coming.
- The Referrals card shows the customer's code in large letters because it is said out loud over a counter, who introduced them, and whom they brought in.
- "The whole story" is every visit, quote, decision and payment as one thread; messages are kept apart because they are matched on an address rather than an id.

WHY IT WORKS

A certain record and a probable one are never mixed, and every card says its rule beside its figure so nobody promises points on a sign-up.

All customers

COMPANY

Pennine Plumbing Ltd

Source: Fleet contract

How this came to be | New job

Contact

MOBILE
Not recorded

LANDLINE
0161 496 5522

EMAIL
accounts@pennineplumbing.test

ADDRESS
Not recorded

TAX NUMBER
GB338201774

MARKETING CONSENT
EMAIL YES | SMS NO

Vehicles

3 vehicles

2019 Ford Transit Custom BV19 FLM
Not recorded · 0 history entries
Passport

2021 Vauxhall Combo Cargo BJ21 OYD
74,900 km · 0 history entries
Passport

2020 Vauxhall Vivaro BX70 KHT
118,240 km · 45 history entries
Passport

Recent jobs

#10486	Rear coil springs	Vauxhall Vivaro	11/09/2026	PAYMENT
#10485	Battery and alternator belt	Ford Transit Custom	11/09/2026	PAYMENT
#10484	Front discs and pads	Vauxhall Combo Cargo	11/09/2026	REPAIR
#10483	Clutch judder under load	Vauxhall Vivaro	11/09/2026	CUSTOMER APPROVAL

Preferences

Preselected on a new job; the diary has the last word

Asks for: Nobody in particular

Save preference

Account

Outstanding £1,284.00

Invoices 1

Money held

A deposit before the work, or credit kept from a refund

Held £0.00

Deposit: 200.00

How they paid: Card

For which job: Not a particular job

Optional

Reference

Optional

Take the deposit

Points

1 point a pound on every bill paid in full

Balance 0

Nothing earned yet. The first bill they pay in full starts it.

Points

Why: Sorry about the wait on Tu

Add points

Referrals

Both sides get 500 points once the person brought in has had £50 of work done

THEIR CODE TO HAND OUT

6NNK7D

Nobody brought in yet.

Arrived with a code: XXXXXX

Somebody else's code, said at the counter

Use the code

Recent payments

Nothing recorded.

The whole story

Every visit, quote, decision and payment, newest first.

13 Sept 26	Booked in for Cambelt and water pump	
11 Sept 26	Vauxhall Combo Cargo came in for Front discs and pads Job 10484	
11 Sept 26	Vauxhall Vivaro came in for Clutch judder under load Job 10483	
11 Sept 26	Booked in for Diagnostics — intermittent EML	
24 May 26	Invoiced INV-1036	£1,284.00
13 Feb 26	Ford Transit Custom: Battery and alternator belt Job 10485	

A customer's page.

Source: docs/02-design/01-domain-model.md, section 3.6

---

14. The vehicle and its passport

The document a car would carry

Phase 1 as a list; Phase 23, 12 September 2026, as a passport.

WHY IT WAS MADE

A record that belongs to a car should look like the document a car would carry. The page is the document: a cover, an identity page with the particulars and a machine-readable zone, a page of observations, and pages of stamps, one per entry, pressed by whoever recorded it.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The seal is the chain verification; it says "History intact" under the foil, in words.
- The stamp ink is the verification level: petrol for workshop-verified, blue for recorded, brass for self-reported, red for a contradiction or a recall.
- The passport number is the chain head, and the zone checks digit for digit as a travel document's does.
- A transfer stamp names nobody. No owner is named anywhere on the document.
- The paper, ink, cover and foil do not follow dark mode, because a document does not.

WHY IT WORKS

Every part carries a fact; nothing could be removed without removing information. It is honest about what it does not cover, in the same type as what it does. And it is the same component for the buyer, the owner and the workshop, so nobody can be shown a different story.

PASSPORT

As the next owner will see it

The document a buyer receives through a share link, word for word. No owner is named on it.

CARNET

VEHICLE PASSPORT

MK20 XRT

PARTICULARS OF THE VEHICLE 01

BMW
X5

MK20 XRT

HISTORY INTACT

FA32-BF75

2020 BMW X5

TYPE P	CODE CNT
PASSPORT NUMBER FA32-BF75	REGISTRATION MK20 XRT
VEHICLE IDENTIFICATION NUMBER WBAJA9C509G000000	
MAKE BMW	MODEL X5
YEAR 2020	FIRST REGISTERED 03 Mar 2020
ENTRIES ON RECORD 108	WORKSHOPS CONTRIBUTING 2
OWNERS ON RECORD 3	LATEST ODOMETER 50,000 km
MILEAGE ANOMALIES 1 contradiction	OPEN RECALLS 1

This record is append-only. Each entry is linked to the one before it, so an entry cannot be altered or removed without breaking the chain. The seal recomputes it.

```
P<CNTBMW<<X5<<2020<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<<
WBAJA9C509G0000009MK20<XRT<52003038030108<4<
```

OBSERVATIONS 02

WHAT THIS RECORD AMOUNTS TO

The record is intact, and it has things in it to ask about.

WHAT IT DOES NOT COVER

The record starts in April 2022, and the vehicle was first registered in March 2020. About 2 years before that is not covered here at all.

This covers what participating workshops recorded. Work done elsewhere, or by the owner, does not appear.

WORTH ASKING THE SELLER

2 critical items were found and have not been recorded as put right. Ask for the invoice, not a description.

1 manufacturer recall shows as outstanding. A franchised dealer does these free; ask whether it has been done and is simply unrecorded.

1 odometer reading did not follow the one before it. That has innocent explanations, and it also has one that is not. Ask.

WHO HAS OWNED IT

Owner 1, kept it 3 years.

Owner 2, kept it 2 years.

Owner 3, kept it 14 months and still has it.

No owner is named on these pages, past or present. That is theirs, not the vehicle's.

OUTSTANDING RECALL

EGR cooler coolant leak — fire risk BMW-0072340100

MILEAGE 03

The mileage record

Checked across every workshop that has recorded a reading. 6 on file.

The mileage record contradicts itself. One reading is impossible given the others.

The odometer read 3,350 fewer miles on 2 July 2025 than it had on 19 March 2025. ARITHMETIC

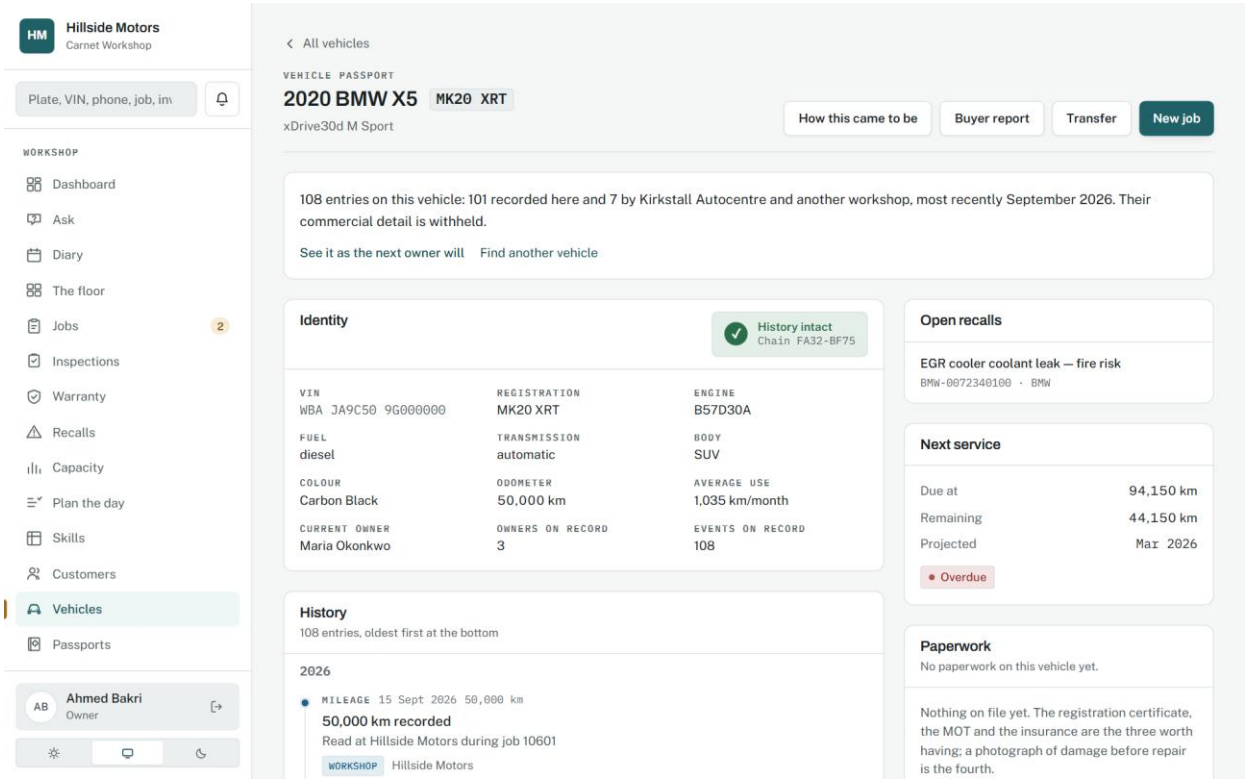
The reading fell from 78,150 to 74,800. An odometer does not go backwards on its own. Either the instrument cluster was replaced, which a workshop should have recorded, or the reading was altered.

ABOUT THE RECORD ITSELF

Nothing recorded between 14 April 2022 and 2 November 2023.

This checks the readings against each other. It cannot see mileage covered while nobody was writing anything down, and it is not a warranty.

A vehicle's passport as the next owner will see it.



The vehicle's own page, with the passport as the way in.

Source: docs/02-design/10-passport-design.md

---

15. Passports, listed

How many are sound, before how many there are

Phase 27, 14 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

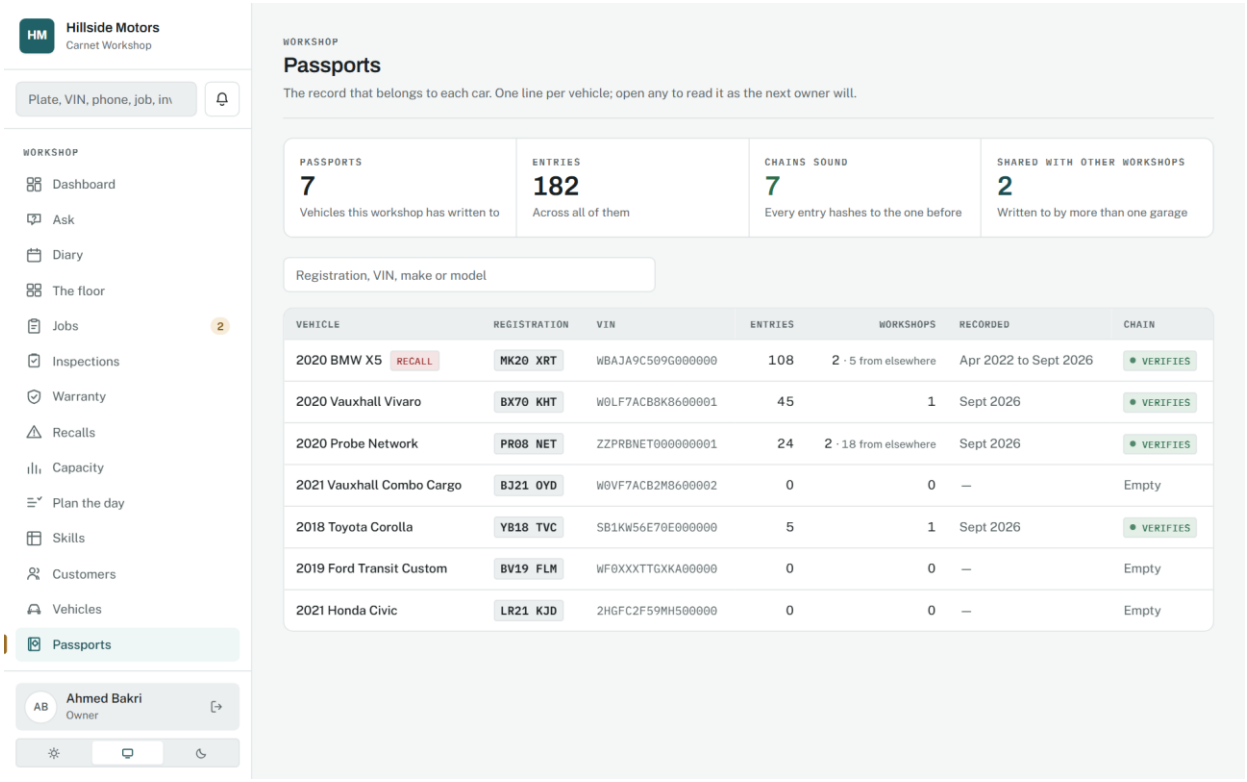
A passport per vehicle had existed since the first phase; nobody could see them side by side. An owner asking how many cars the workshop has written to, and whether every chain is sound, had to open each one.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- The third tile, chains sound, is the one that matters; it turns red when it is not the same number as the first.
- "From elsewhere" counts entries other workshops wrote: the network, counted.
- The verdict is computed per vehicle on request, never cached, because a stored verdict about a chain would be the one stored fact the design forbids.

WHY IT WORKS

The rule generalises: when a page has one figure that means somebody must act today, it is the first tile that changes colour, and it changes only when it is non-zero.



Passports, listed.

Source: docs/02-design/09-wireframes.md, section 9; docs/02-design/08-design-system.md, section 13

---

16. The portal

Plain English, on a phone, in a car park

Phase 1, 9 September 2026; accounts and claiming a car in Phase 15.1; points, referrals and passports in Phases 24 to 27.

WHY IT WAS MADE

Maria knows nothing about cars and does not want to. Every status is in plain language, every figure is explained, and the whole thing works on a phone with one hand.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

- Her vehicles are hers, across every workshop that uses Carnet, not one garage's list.
- Points and a referral code are shown per workshop, with the rule in the same breath.
- Her passports are one card each: whether the record is sound, how much of the car's life is in it, and how to show it to a buyer.
- The passport she sees is the document a buyer sees, word for word, so she knows what she is handing over.

WHY IT WORKS

Forty-four pixel targets, no hover, and no jargon. A portal is judged in a supermarket car park, not in a design review.

Carnet
YOUR CARS

EN FR AR

Hello, Maria

3 things need your attention.

Add a car | Book a visit

NEEDS YOU

ESTIMATE TO APPROVE

BMW X5 · Brake system repair

Hillside Motors · estimated £1,509.00

Review and decide

INVOICE TO PAY

£750.00

INV-1039 from Hillside Motors

Pay by card

SAFETY RECALL

2020 BMW X5

The manufacturer has an open safety recall on this car. The fix is free; book it in.

Book the recall

MY CARS

2020
BMW X5
MK20 XRT

50,000 km · 108 entries on its passport

Customer approval

Open →

2021
Honda Civic
LR21 KJD

Not recorded · 0 entries on its passport

Nothing due

Open →

RECENT WORK

Brake system repair

BMW X5 · Hillside Motors · 11 Sept 2026

CUSTOMER APPROVAL

REWARDS

4,233 points

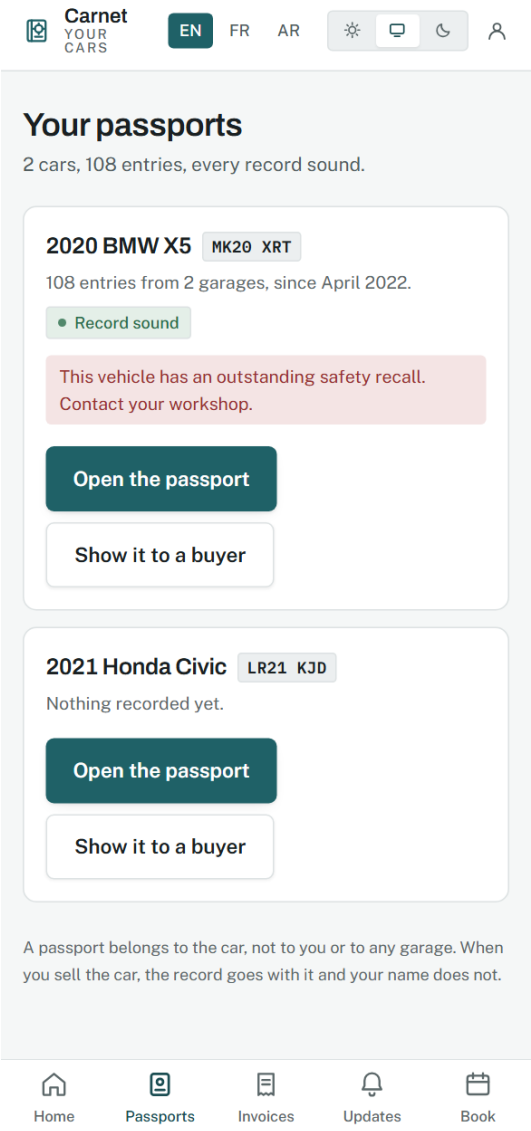
Your points and a code that brings a friend.

YOUR PASSPORTS

Every car's full history, verified, in one place. Share it with a buyer when you sell.

See passports

The portal home.



Her passports.

← Back to the vehicle

Show this to somebody

CARNET

VEHICLE PASSPORT

MK20 XRT

PARTICULARS OF THE VEHICLE 01

BMW
X5

MK20 XRT

HISTORY INTACT

FA32-BF75

2020 BMW X5

TYPE
P

CODE
CNT

PASSPORT NUMBER
FA32-BF75

REGISTRATION
MK20 XRT

VEHICLE IDENTIFICATION NUMBER
WBAJA9C509G000000

MAKE
BMW

MODEL
X5

YEAR
2020

FIRST REGISTERED
03 Mar 2020

ENTRIES ON RECORD
108

WORKSHOPS CONTRIBUTING

Her passport, on paper, on a phone.

Source: docs/02-design/08-design-system.md, section 6

---

17. Reputation, answers, people and the business

Screens that decide nothing

Phases 12, 15, 16 and 17, 11 to 12 September 2026.

WHY IT WAS MADE

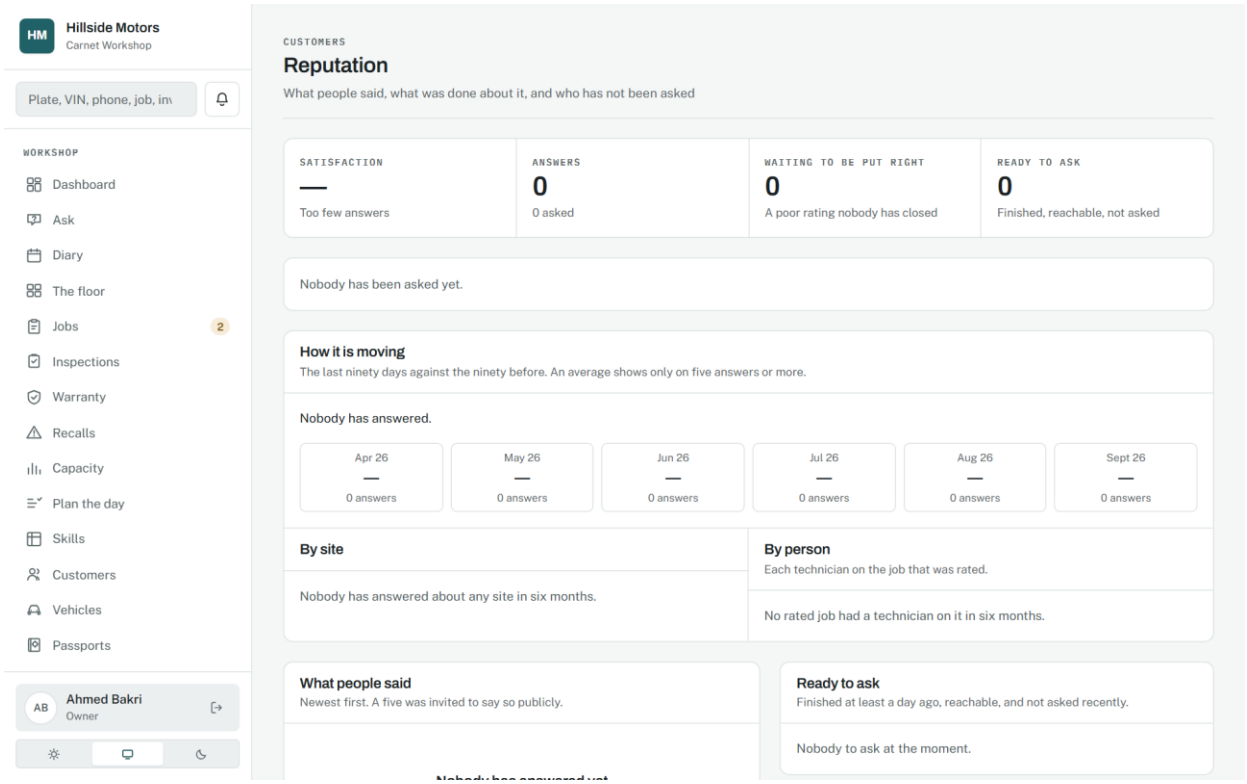
These pages exist to answer questions from the record: who to ask for a review and who not to, what the records can say in words, who can do what and where the workshop is one person deep, and what the business made. None of them changes a record until a person presses the button that does.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

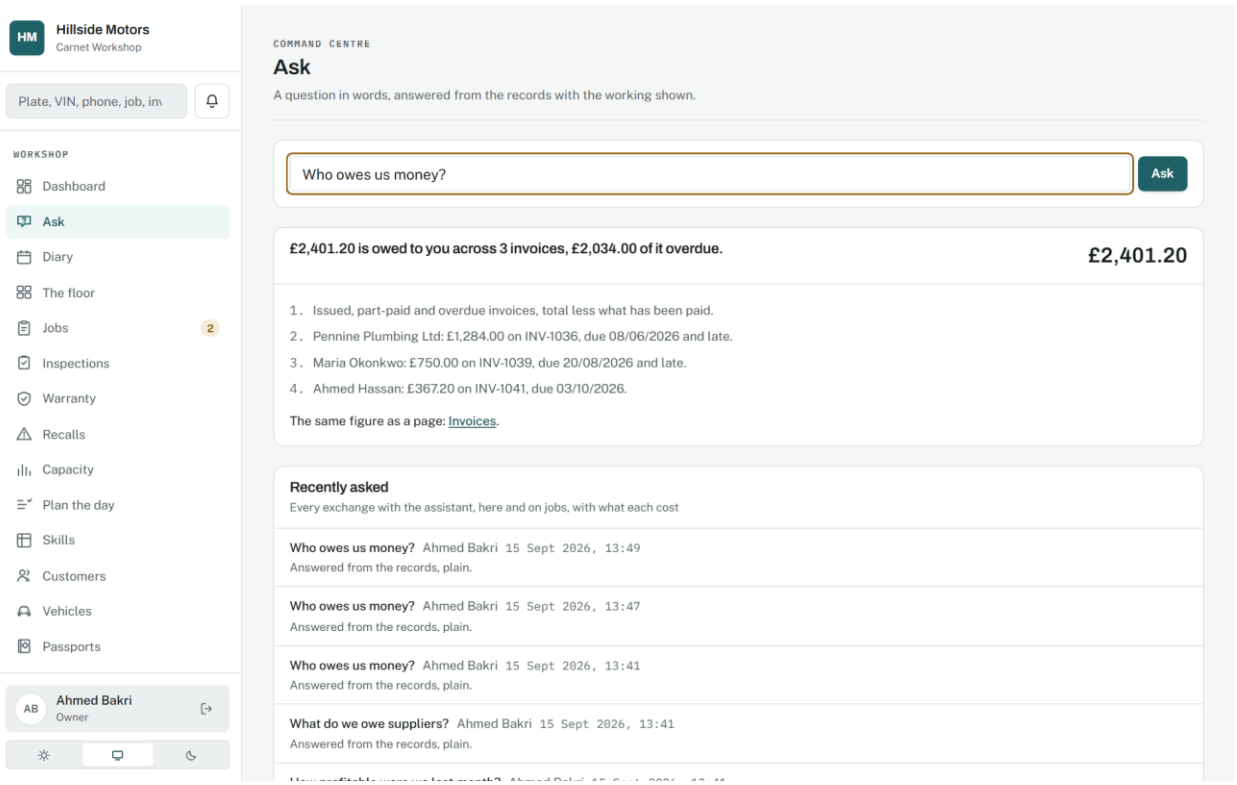
- Reputation routes by the answer: a five is invited to say so publicly; three or less opens a conversation instead.
- Ask has a closed vocabulary routed to calculations the product already trusts, with the working shown.
- People shows utilisation, efficiency and productivity per person, presented as operations rather than a league table.
- The business report is revenue, margin, retention and the parts sold at a loss.

WHY IT WORKS

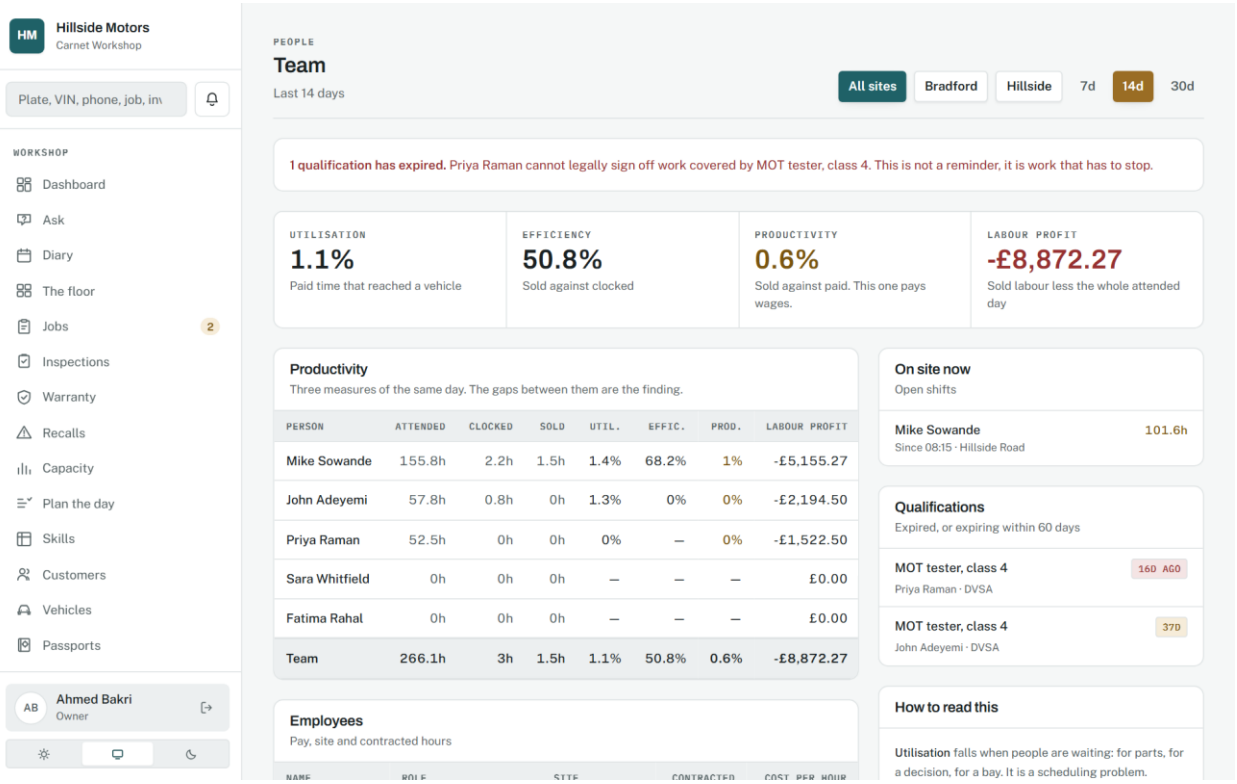
Satisfaction is refused below five answers rather than swung by one, and every figure names the calculation behind it.



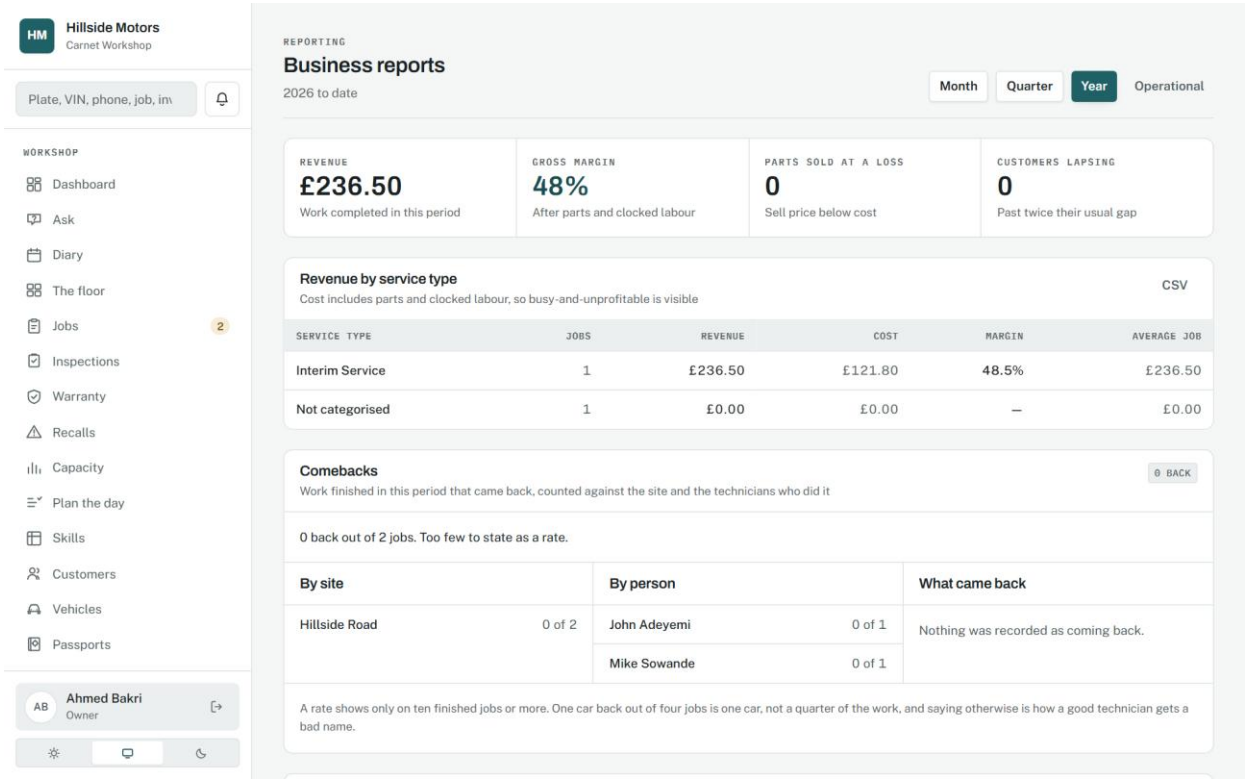
Reputation.



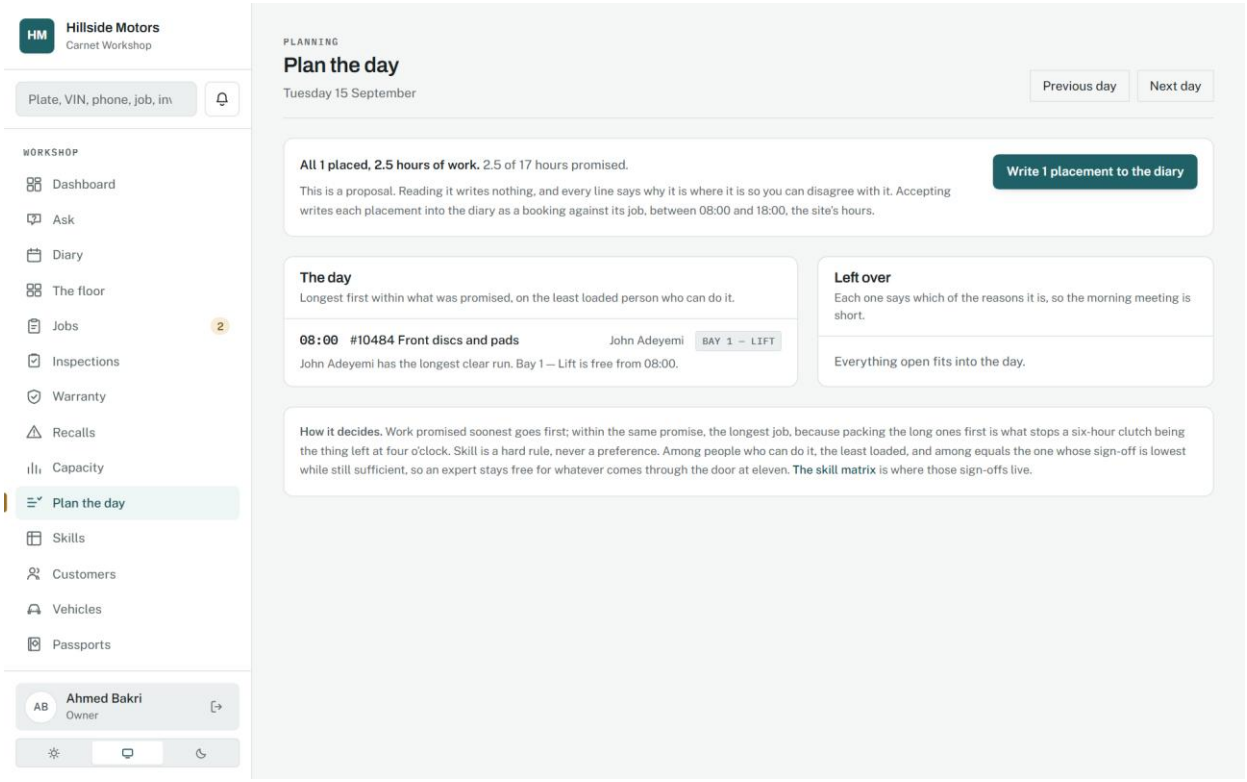
A question answered from the records.



People.



The business report.



The day, planned.

Source: docs/00-product/06-roadmap.md, Phases 12, 15, 16 and 17; ADR-0013

18. Dark mode, empty states, and the page that is not there

Both themes designed, nothing waits on a blank screen

Phase 1, 9 September 2026; the loading car in Phase 4.9; the stranded car in Phase 15.1.

WHY IT WAS MADE

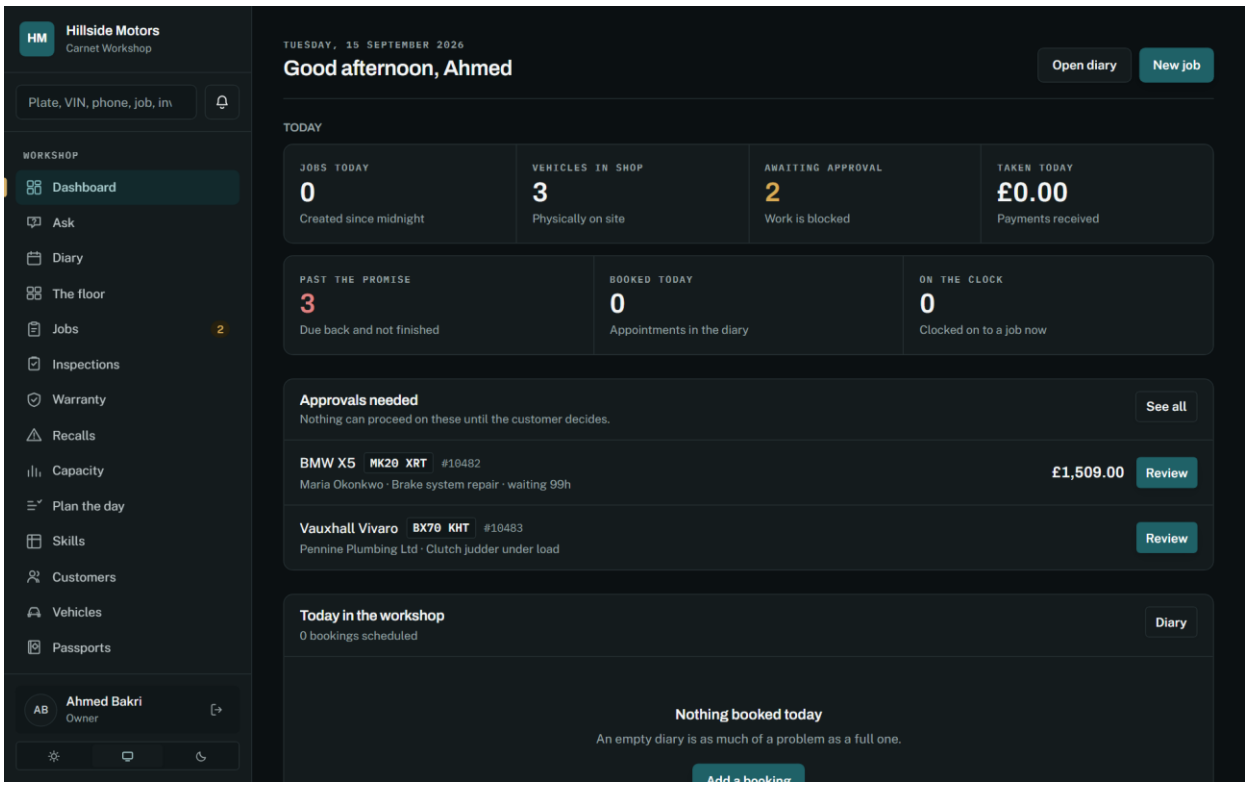
Dark mode is designed rather than inverted, with brand and accent lightened so contrast holds both ways. Every list has a bound and every empty page says what to do next. A page that does not exist shows a car with nowhere to go, drawn in the product's own terms, rather than an error code.

WHAT EACH PART MEANS

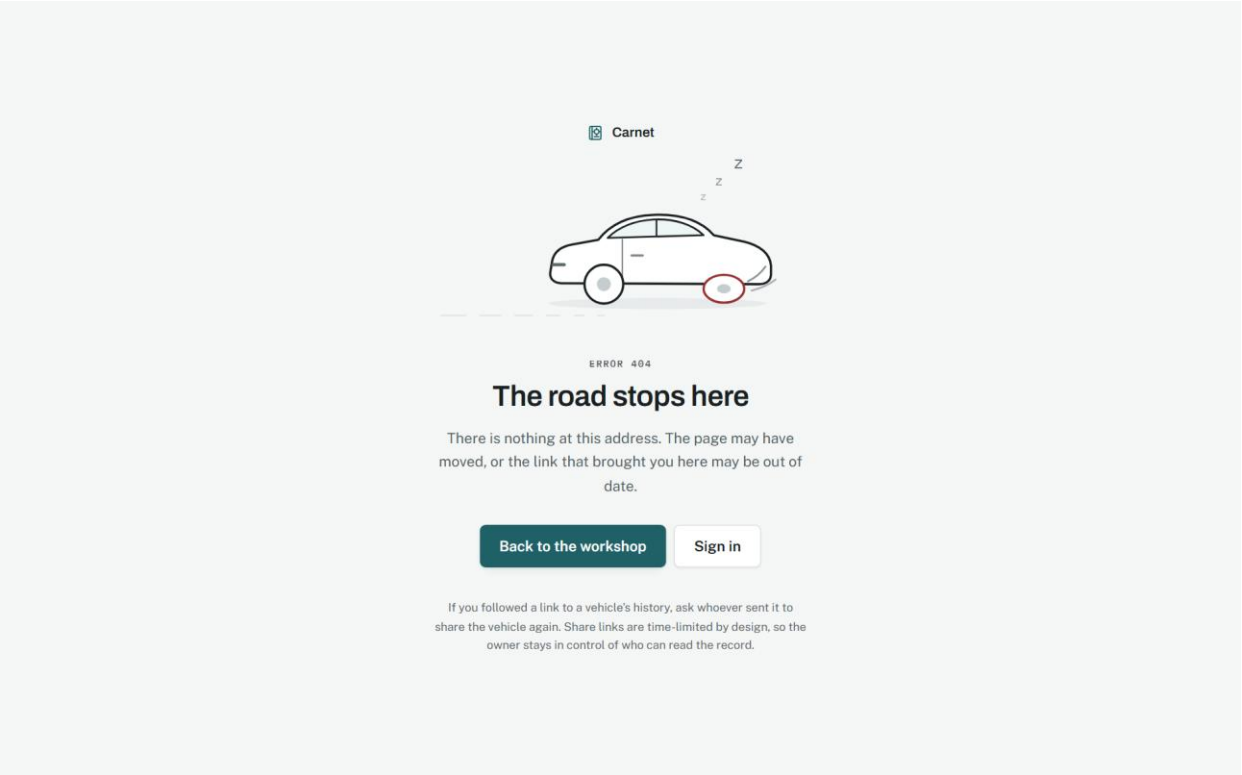
- Tokens are redefined for dark; no component references a raw colour, so nothing is missed.
- The empty-state crawl opens every page with nothing in it and fails on one that does not say what to do.
- Where a page cannot render immediately, a car being worked on stands in for a spinner.

WHY IT WORKS

These are the moments a product is usually caught out, so they are designed and verified like any other screen.



The dashboard in dark mode.



The page that is not there.

Source: docs/02-design/08-design-system.md, sections 8 and 9

---

19. What the design refuses to do

Some of the strongest decisions are absences, and a reader of this book should know them.

- It never claims more than is true. The passport says "recorded by a workshop" or "recorded with photographic evidence", because those are different things and a buyer is entitled to weigh them.
- It never clamps. A redemption, a payment, a refund or a transition that would make a figure wrong is refused with a sentence that says what to do instead.
- It never stores a derived truth. Balances, verdicts, totals and statuses are computed from the entries beneath them, so two screens cannot disagree.
- It never names an owner on a shared document, and never shows a price, a margin or a note to anybody the record is not for.
- It never lets colour carry meaning alone, and never depends on hover on the shop floor.
- It never leaves a button with nothing behind it. A crawl reads every page for every role and fails on one.

Sources. The design system: docs/02-design/08-design-system.md. The passport: docs/02-design/10-passport-design.md. The wireframes: docs/02-design/09-wireframes.md. The accounting behind the money screens: docs/02-design/07-accounting-model.md. The phases: docs/00-product/06-roadmap.md.